DCS DYNAMIC SANDBOX MISSION

FOOTHOLD

MISSION MANUAL v2.6

A comprehensive guide to the DCS Foothold sandbox mission

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1. Introduction and How to Start

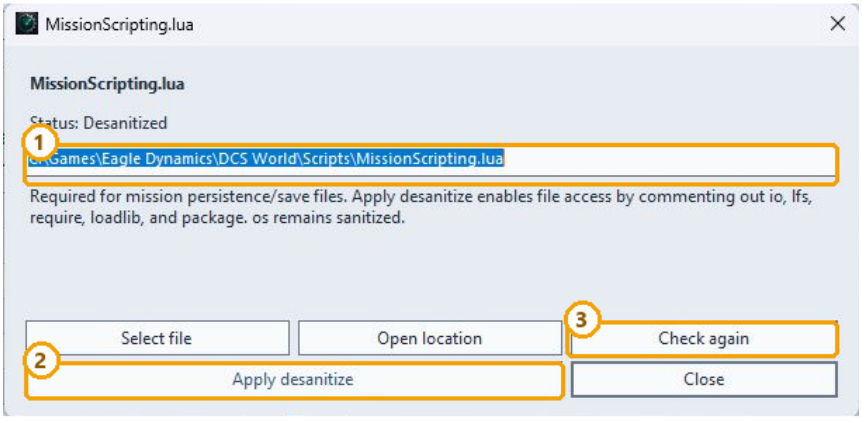
Foothold is a multiplayer sandbox campaign available on several maps. In PvE your coalition defeats the enemy and clears its zones. Caucasus also supports optional PvP, where Blue and Red both capture territory, manage logistics and purchase support. See Section 12 for the PvP setup and rules.

All kills in Foothold will reward the player personally. Those credits can then be used by the whole coalition to upgrade friendly zones, purchase SEAD / CAS, Bomb run and more to attack the enemy. To redeem your credits, after you kill enemy units, you need to land safely at a friendly airbase. All the credits are coalition based. Some missions will reward the player with a bigger payout, for example for completing a strike mission. Same logic is applied — players need to land to redeem the credit.

How to Start

Foothold Config Manager provides the MissionScripting panel for mission persistence. Open the manager and select the MissionScripting status button along the bottom edge.

- Confirm that the displayed path points to the DCS installation used by the mission. Use Select file or Open location if you need to choose it manually.
- Select Apply desanitize, then use Check again. When Status reads Desanitized and the main button reads MissionScripting OK, close the dialog.



MissionScripting setup in Foothold Config Manager

IMPORTANT
This needs to be done after EVERY DCS update!

Performance Tip
Disable Tacview. Tacview eats performance as it records every unit on the map.

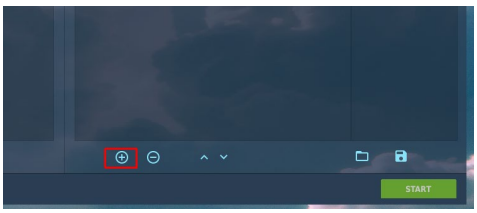
DCS updates can restore the original MissionScripting.lua. If Foothold stops creating save files, open this panel and check the status again.

Use Foothold Config Manager for configuration. Do not open the miz as a ZIP or manually move Foothold Config.lua; the first-run wizard described in Section 2.1 installs it in the correct location.

This mission is designed to be used in multiplayer mode only. Even if you intend to play alone, you still need to run the mission in the multiplayer environment due to dynamic spawn and other factors. Select the mission and then select START.



Select the mission in multiplayer and click NEW SERVER



Select the Foothold mission and press START

2. Mission Options and Config

2.1 Config File Location

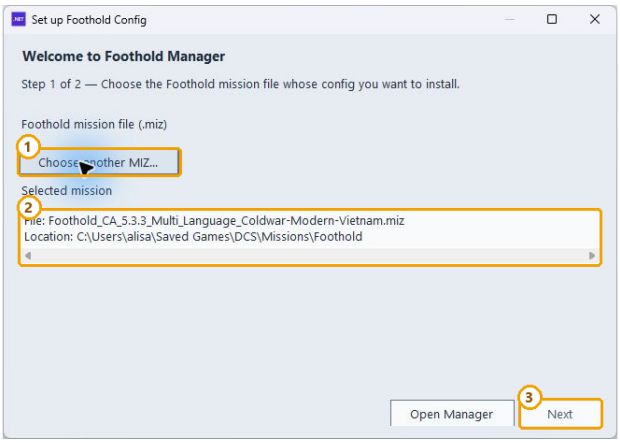
Foothold Config Manager installs Foothold Config.lua through a two-step wizard the first time it opens. This replaces the old 7-Zip/WinRAR extraction and manual file-copy process.

First-time setup wizard

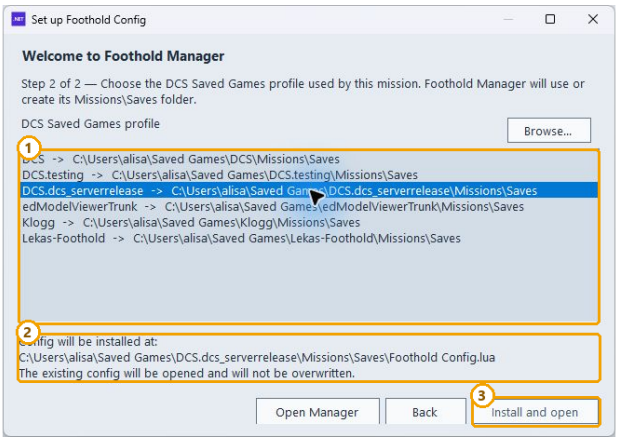
Step 1 — Select Choose MIZ, browse to the Foothold mission, confirm the selected mission, and select Next.

Step 2 — Choose the DCS Saved Games profile used by the mission. The manager shows the exact install path under Config will be installed at.

Select Install and open. The manager creates Missions\Saves when needed, installs the correct Normal or WW2 config, validates it, and opens it. If a config already exists, the manager opens it without overwriting your settings.



Step 1: choose and confirm the Foothold mission



Step 2: select the DCS profile, then install and open

Normal config location: Saved Games > DCS profile > Missions > Saves > Foothold Config.lua

Use Open Manager if you only want to open an existing configuration. The mission progress save files remain separate for the mission era and are not overwritten by this setup wizard.

2.2 Cold War / Modern Era

In Foothold Config Manager, open Mission Rules and choose Modern, Coldwar, Gulfwar, or Vietnam under Era. When offered, confirm the era-based template selection to update the checked mission templates. Changing Era alone does not silently untick every incompatible aircraft; review the choices and validation messages. Section 2.3 explains the matching Aircraft / Weapons lists.

> **Important!**
> When wanting to switch to the cold war era, you have to change the warehouse from unlimited to limited otherwise it won't work! The warehouse items are now default limited; for the cold war, you only need to set the planes to unlimited.

The illustrations below show the relevant controls.

> **Ships Warning**
> Do NOT do this on ships. Ships need to be done manually. Go to the CVN-72, CVN-73, CVN-74, CVN-59 and Tarawa (can be 2) and do the same.

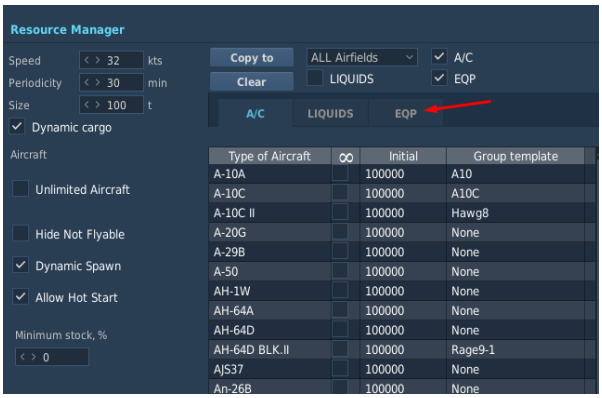


1. Left-click inside the airport circle to open the warehouse.

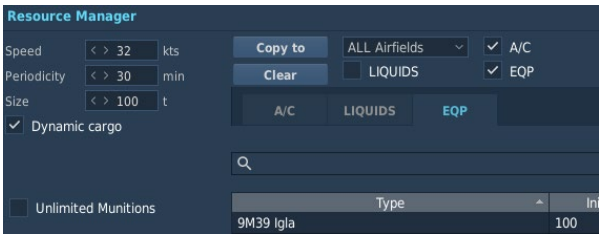
2. Select FULL INFO.



3. Disable Unlimited Aircraft, enable A/C and EQP, then open EQP.



4. Disable Unlimited Munitions.
(Might be already disabled)



5. For mod support, select All, fill the EQP column, then copy the warehouse settings to all RED/BLUE airfields and FARPs.

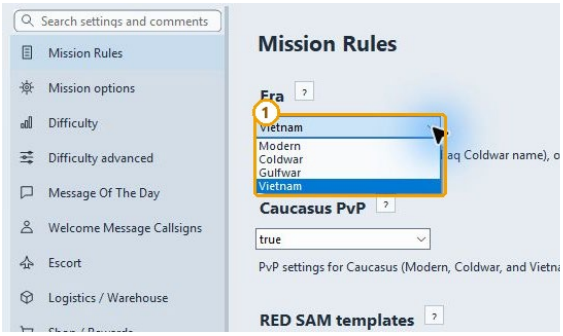


2.3 Era, Aircraft, and Weapon Settings in Config Manager

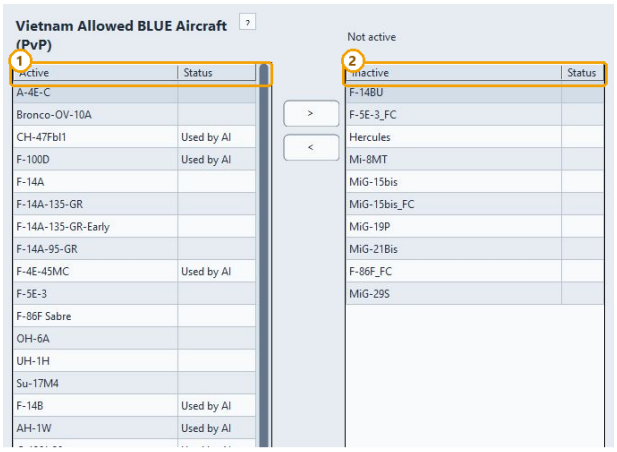
Config Manager

Use Foothold Config Manager for era, aircraft, and weapon setup. In Mission Rules, choose the Era and review the offered template changes. Accepting that prompt updates the linked template rows. Leaving templates enabled can keep their aircraft required, even when their Era tag differs.

Open Aircraft / Weapons. In PvE, Coldwar/Gulfwar and Vietnam show the existing Blue aircraft list. In PvP, those eras use one shared list unless Different aircraft per coalition is enabled; that option shows one Blue and one Red list instead. Modern has no ordinary aircraft list unless separate PvP lists are enabled. Weapon restrictions remain shared between coalitions.



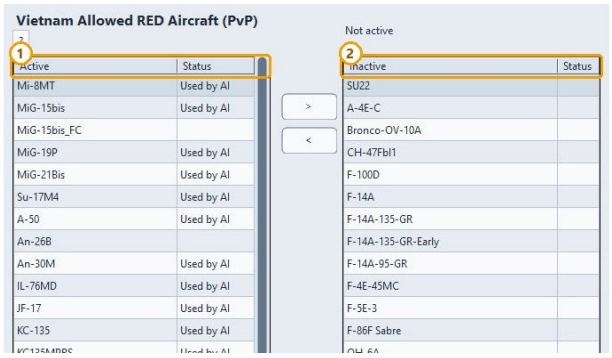
Step 1: choose the era in Mission Rules



The Aircraft / Weapons page changes with the selected era

Active and Inactive items

Items in Active are enabled; items in Inactive are disabled. Use the arrow buttons to move entries. Coldwar and Vietnam have their own warehouse aircraft lists; PvP can share a list or use separate Blue and Red lists. Weapon restrictions remain shared. Forbidden Weapons All Eras applies across eras.



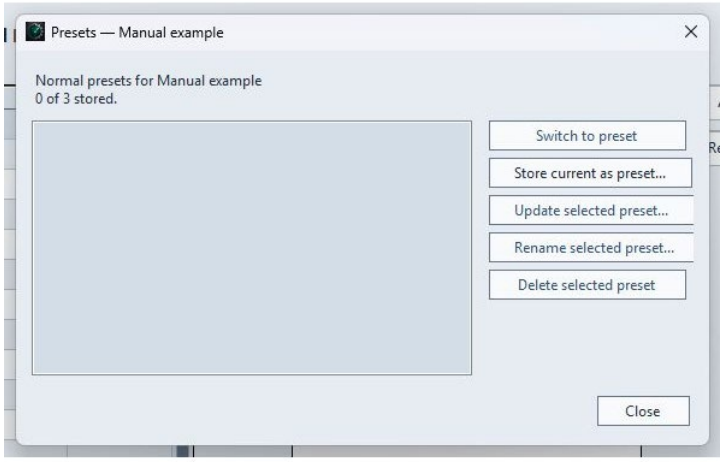
Separate PvP lists show the Red aircraft choices using the same Active and Inactive controls.

Date and Year

The mission date cannot be changed by script. For a Cold War mission, set the date in the Mission Editor; the recommended year is 1989 and for Vietnam the recommended year is 1975.

Presets

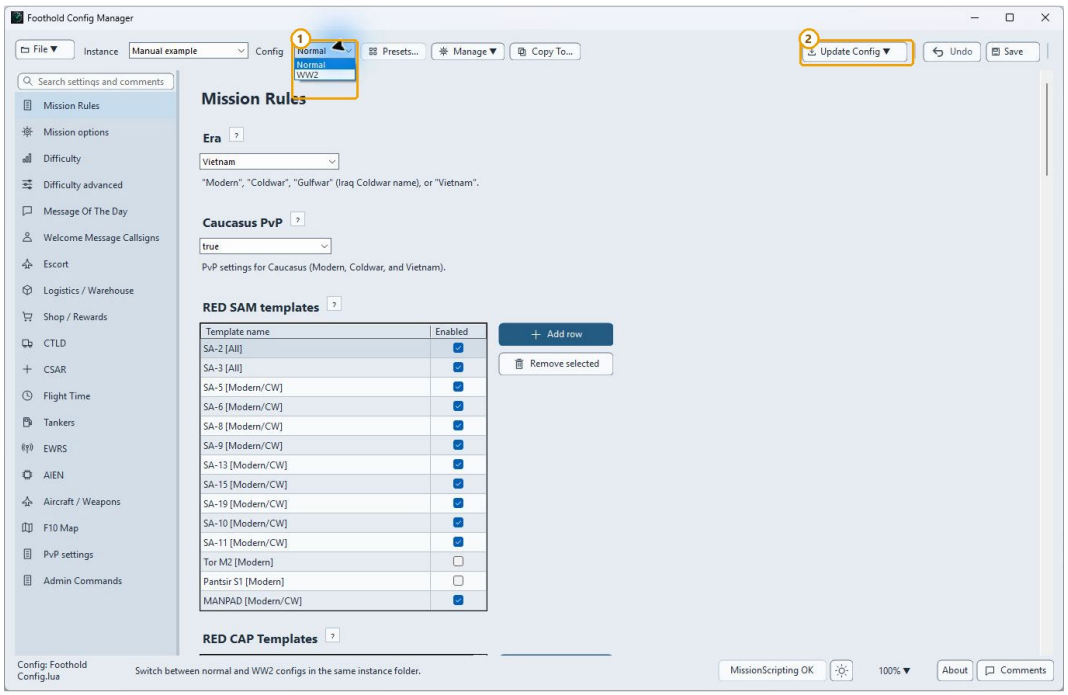
Presets keeps up to three named setups for each selected instance and config type. Use Store current as preset after configuring an era. Save or reload pending changes before Switch to preset. Update, Rename, and Delete maintain the stored snapshots; switching validates and backs up the live config before loading the selected preset.



Store and switch between reusable configurations

2.4 Foothold Config Manager and Options Reference

Use Foothold Config Manager to edit Foothold Config.lua through a categorized interface. It loads the active config, explains supported values, validates changes, and saves without opening the mission archive.



Install a WW2 config from its mission, then switch between Normal and WW2

Main controls

- Instance and Config — select the DCS profile/instance and the Normal or WW2 configuration.
- File contains Open Config, Reload and Restore Defaults. Update Config imports a mission or another Config. Undo reverses an unsaved action; Save writes the current Config.
- Presets — store, switch, update, rename, or delete up to three named setups for the selected instance and config type. Manage adds, renames, or removes instances; Copy To copies settings to another instance.

Updating for a new Foothold release

Choose Update Config > Update from MIZ and select the new mission. Review changed defaults and decide whether each setting keeps its current value or uses the new mission value. The manager validates the result and creates a timestamped backup of the current config; the five most recent backups are retained.

Use Update from Config File to merge from another Foothold config instead of a mission file.

Normal and WW2 configurations

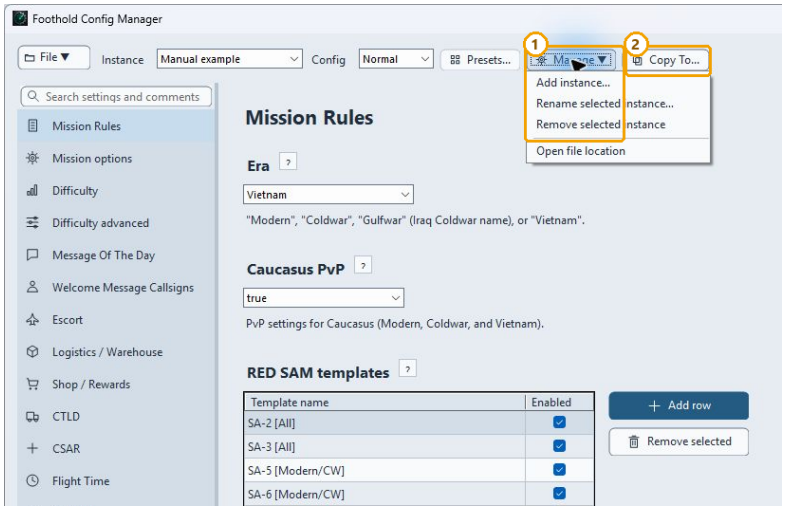
The Config selector appears when both Foothold Config.lua and Foothold Config WW2.lua are present in the selected instance's Missions\Saves folder. With only the Normal config installed, the selector is hidden.

To add WW2, select the correct Instance, then choose Update Config > Update from MIZ and select a Foothold WW2 mission, such as the Normandy .miz. Confirm Install WW2 Config. The manager installs the WW2 config beside the Normal config and opens it. Use Config to switch between Normal and WW2.

This selector chooses which config file to edit. Modern, Coldwar, Gulfwar, and Vietnam remain Era choices within Normal.

Instances and reuse

Use Manage to add, rename, or remove an instance. Use Copy To when the same settings should be applied to another DCS profile or server instance.



Manage multiple DCS profiles and server instances

Configuration sections

The left panel groups related settings into the sections below. Select a section, edit its fields, review any validation messages, then choose Save.

Use the ? buttons for field-specific values and cautions. Easy, medium, and hard profiles provide a safe starting point; advanced tables are intended for administrators who need custom scaling.

2.4.1 Mission Rules

Mission Rules chooses the mission era and the mission-editor templates that Foothold is allowed to spawn. A checked row is available; an unchecked row remains in the config but cannot be selected. The named template must also exist in the mission file, so a check box cannot create a missing aircraft or SAM group.

Era — Selects Modern, Coldwar, Gulfwar, or Vietnam. Choosing an era offers matching template changes and refreshes the Aircraft / Weapons page; review and accept the prompt to update the linked templates. Use the preset system if you regularly switch the same server between eras.

RED SAM templates — Controls which RED surface-to-air defence templates can be used when zones build or restore their air defences. Disable a row to prevent that complete system from being selected; this does not delete already-spawned units from an active save.

RED CAP Templates — The RED fighter loadouts available for patrols, interceptions, counter-attacks, and other air-to-air tasks. Entries ending in 1SHIP, 2SHIP, or 3SHIP describe the formation size already built into the mission template.

BLUE CAP Templates — Friendly fighter loadouts used by automatic BLUE support and purchased CAP. The active difficulty profile controls how many may operate; this list controls which loadouts may be chosen.

RED CAS Plane Templates — RED fixed-wing close-air-support loadouts used against BLUE zones and ground forces. Difficulty limits the active number; this table limits the available aircraft and weapons.

BLUE CAS Plane Templates — Friendly fixed-wing close-air-support loadouts used by BLUE support or purchased attacks.

RED SEAD Plane Templates — RED suppression-of-enemy-air-defence flights. These aircraft are selected to attack hostile air defences and may carry anti-radiation weapons.

BLUE SEAD Plane Templates — Friendly SEAD loadouts used by support or shop actions where the map provides the matching templates.

RED Runway Strike Templates — RED strike packages that can bomb BLUE runways. Their active limit follows Runway Strike Difficulty.

RED CAS Helo Templates — RED attack-helicopter loadouts used for zone attacks. Bombing an airfield runway does not stop these helicopters.

BLUE CAS Helo Templates — Friendly attack-helicopter loadouts used by automatic or purchased support.

RED Supply Helo Templates — RED transport-helicopter groups eligible for AI supply missions when the map and supply logic allow them.

BLUE Supply Helo Templates — BLUE transport-helicopter groups eligible for AI supply missions. Their stock movement and timing are controlled under Logistics / Warehouse.

2.4.2 Mission options

Mission options contain mission-wide switches. These values affect new events after the mission starts; changing a saved mission does not retroactively rebuild units, warehouse contents, or already-active tasks.

Foothold Locale — Sets the language used for global on-screen messages and other shared text. Individual players can still change supported radio-menu language for themselves.

Start Normal — On Caucasus, Persian Gulf, Syria, and Afghanistan, ON starts the normal Foothold direction. OFF reverses the start and disables the carrier zone. Other maps do not support the reversed start.

Start From Incirlik — Syria only. When Start Normal is ON, ON starts Foothold from Incirlik instead of Akrotiri. OFF keeps Akrotiri. This setting has no effect when Start Normal is OFF.

Remove Southern Syria — Syria only. ON removes the southern Syria Foothold zones while preserving current progress in the remaining zones. Turning it OFF later returns the removed zones in their default setup state.

Auto Restart — ON resets and restarts automatically after victory. OFF leaves a post-victory radio-menu choice so an administrator can decide when to restart.

Disable MANTIS — OFF keeps MANTIS active: RED SAMs depend on EWR detection, may stay silent until a player is detected, and mobile systems may shut down or move when threatened by anti-radiation weapons, TALD decoys, or JSOW. ON removes that behaviour and uses the mission's simpler SAM operation.

Use Statics — Includes configured static targets such as command centers, ammunition depots, fuel tanks, and factories in supported zones. OFF ignores those statics in the relevant Foothold target logic.

PVE Only — ON prevents players who join RED from spawning in RED-held Foothold zones. It does not remove RED AI; it limits player use of the hostile coalition.

Allow Mods (AllowMods) — Lets Warehouse Logistics restock supported mod weapons and exposes the related restock-aircraft list. Do not use it for Cold War or Gulf War eras. Weapons added after a save already exists appear gradually through Auto Fill Resources rather than being inserted instantly.

Lose Coalition Credits When Killed — ON deducts the configured Coalition Credit Loss from the side when a player aircraft is lost. The default loss is 100 coalition credits.

Coalition Credit Loss — The number of coalition shop credits removed for each eligible player-aircraft loss when the preceding switch is ON.

Lose Rank Credits When Killed — ON deducts personal rank credits when a player aircraft is lost. It only applies while Ranking System is ON.

Rank Credit Loss — The number of personal rank credits removed for an eligible loss. The default is 100.

Splash Damage — Loads the enhanced blast-damage system for bombs. It can make explosions more effective against nearby units but may add noticeable stutter on large or busy missions.

Show Kills — ON displays Foothold kill notifications. OFF leaves normal reward and mission logic active without the extra Foothold kill messages.

Store Limit — ON applies personal-earned-credit gates to expensive shop items: purchases above configured cost bands require the buyer to have earned enough rank credit. It works with the Ranking System and the per-item rank requirements under Shop / Rewards.

Ranking System — ON records lifetime earned credits in Foothold_Ranks.lua, assigns titles, and enables rank requirements and rank-loss rules. OFF gives everyone access to the full shop except for other explicit restrictions.

Friendly Fire Rank Penalty — Personal rank credits deducted for a qualifying friendly-fire event while the ranking system is active. It is separate from coalition-credit loss on death.

Invisible A-10 — ON excludes A-10s from RED fighter target categories. It also overrides Chance AI Attack Helicopters, so use this only when the mission intentionally protects that close-air-support role.

Carrier Rank Requirement — Minimum rank level used for carrier-control access on maps that apply the carrier rank gate. When Ranking System is OFF, the rank gate is not applied.

Allow Tarawa To Move Freely — On Caucasus, Persian Gulf, and Syria, ON enables BLUE F10 marker commands for Tarawa: tarawahere, tarawahereandstop, tarawahere1, tarawahere2, tarawareturn, and tarawahelp. Routes must stay in allowed territory and valid water; the normal Carrier Navigation menu remains a separate system.

2.4.3 Difficulty

Difficulty separates timing, AI skill, visibility, targeting, and mission-count profiles. A profile such as easy, medium, or hard chooses one column from the matching stage table under Difficulty advanced; it does not directly change every other setting on this page.

AI Spawn Speed Scaling — RED / BLUE — Multiplies non-supply AI attack and patrol timers for each coalition. 1.00 is normal; 0.50 is twice as fast; 1.50 is 50% slower. Supply missions and ready-supply production use the separate Supply Speed Scaling field under Logistics / Warehouse.

RED AI Plane Skill — DCS skill assigned to spawned RED airplanes: Average, Good, High, Excellent, or Random. Random lets the spawn system vary the skill between flights.

RED AI Ground Skill — DCS skill assigned to spawned RED zone-defence ground groups. Unknown text falls back to High.

BLUE AI Ground Skill — DCS skill assigned to spawned BLUE zone-defence ground groups. This changes unit proficiency, not how quickly a zone repairs or upgrades.

Hide SAM On MFD — false always allows the SAM group to appear through normal DCS sensor rules; true always applies the hidden-on-MFD setting; random rolls a 50% hidden chance each time the group spawns. This does not make the SAM physically invisible on the F10 map if other map settings reveal it.

Chance AI Attack Helo — The original PvE setting is locked in PvP. Use PvP settings > PvP Chance AI Attack Helo for the chance applied to the affected air missions on both coalitions. Invisible A-10 still takes precedence.

Enable Hunter — ON allows RED to dispatch a two-aircraft hunter flight after a player inflicts enough damage. Protected or ignored aircraft types still follow the Hunter mechanic's own exclusions.

Director Battlefield Intelligence — ON lets RED remember recent sortie and regular AI supply outcomes and use them to influence planning. OFF disables this intelligence, including its air-combat influence. It does not increase group limits, force launches, bypass cooldowns, or block routes. Default: ON.

Director Air-Combat Intelligence — Controls the extra influence from recent air-combat results when RED redirects an existing CAP. Requires Director Battlefield Intelligence to be ON. OFF disables this extra influence while keeping the other battlefield-intelligence features available. Normal CAP limits, cooldowns, and safety rules still apply. Default: ON.

RED CAP Difficulty — Selects the easy, medium, or hard RED CAP Limit table. One CAP amount represents one patrol plus one attack group, so an amount of 1 can mean two active CAP groups.

RED CAS Difficulty — Selects the active RED fixed-wing CAS limit by counted player population.

RED SEAD Difficulty — Selects the active RED SEAD limit by counted player population.

BLUE CAP Support — Selects the friendly CAP-support limit. Its stage tables deliberately provide more AI help when fewer counted players are online.

BLUE CAS Support — Selects the friendly CAS-support limit by counted player population.

BLUE SEAD Support — Selects the friendly SEAD-support limit by counted player population.

RED Runway Strike Difficulty — Selects the active RED runway-strike limit by counted player population.

RED Reactive Difficulty — Selects the easy, medium, or hard counterpressure and strategic-budget profile used when BLUE pressure builds near RED frontline zones. It controls how readily RED accelerates support or forces a response.

2.4.4 Difficulty advanced

Each stage table contains player / amount rows for easy, medium, and hard. Foothold uses the last row whose player threshold is not greater than the current counted-player total. The final 999 row is the upper catch-all. Edit these tables only when the three standard profiles do not fit the server.

RED CAP Limit — Maximum RED CAP amount for each counted-player threshold. One amount equals one CAP patrol and one CAP attack, so the actual group count can be twice the displayed amount.

RED CAS Limit — Maximum simultaneously active RED CAS flights at each counted-player threshold.

RED SEAD Limit — Maximum simultaneously active RED SEAD flights at each counted-player threshold.

RED Runway Strike Limit — Maximum simultaneously active RED runway-strike flights at each counted-player threshold.

BLUE CAP Support — Maximum automatic friendly CAP support for each counted-player threshold. Lower-player rows normally allow more help.

BLUE CAS Support — Maximum automatic friendly CAS support for each counted-player threshold.

BLUE SEAD Support — Maximum automatic friendly SEAD support for each counted-player threshold.

CAP Count Ignore Types — Checked aircraft types do not increase the player count used by RED CAP and BLUE CAP-support tables. This prevents support aircraft such as A-10s, Harriers, Viggens, and transports from scaling fighter activity as if they were dedicated air-superiority players.

RED CAS Count Ignore Types — Checked aircraft types do not increase the player count used by RED CAS, RED SEAD, and RED runway-strike limit calculations.

BLUE CAS Count Ignore Types — Checked aircraft types do not increase the player count used by BLUE CAS and BLUE SEAD support calculations.

2.4.5 Message Of The Day

This section sends one server-wide text message ten seconds after mission initialization and then repeats it on the configured timer. It is useful for a Discord link, server rules, SRS information, or a short administrator notice.

Enabled — ON starts the repeating message. OFF prevents the scheduler from being created, so Duration, Interval, and Text have no effect.

Duration — Seconds that each message remains visible. The default is 15 seconds; values below one second are treated as one second by the mission.

Interval — Seconds between displays. The default 1,800 seconds is 30 minutes. Values below one second are treated as one second, which would effectively spam the screen and should be avoided.

Text — The exact multiline message shown to every player. Line breaks are preserved, so keep the message short enough to read during the selected Duration.

2.4.6 Welcome Message Callsigns

Foothold assigns a display callsign when a supported aircraft spawns. Players at the same zone are given free flight numbers from the selected callsign family, and the matching code is included in the welcome message. These names are Foothold display names; they do not change the DCS mission-editor group callsign.

Aircraft family — The left-hand aircraft identifier is matched against the spawned group name. Keep the existing identifier unless the mission's group-naming convention has also changed.

Callsign — The editable name used as the base, such as Indy9 or Jester1. Foothold appends flight numbers as slots are assigned and tries to keep one family together at the same zone.

IFF 1–4 — Four optional LotATC identification codes paired with flight numbers 1 through 4. They only become operational IFF information when the same values are configured in LotATC; otherwise leave them unchanged and edit only the callsign text.

Multiple rows for one aircraft — Provides alternative callsign families when another family is already in use. Removing every row for an aircraft removes its custom welcome-message assignment.

2.4.7 Escort

Escort settings control the optional two-fighter escort intended mainly for slower strike, attack, and transport aircraft. Each aircraft row contains three independent values: access, escort type, and vertical offset.

Aircraft — The player-aircraft type to which the row applies. A row only affects that exact DCS type name.

Enabled — ON makes the escort option available after that aircraft spawns. OFF keeps the row and its other settings but does not offer the escort.

Escort type — 1 selects Hornets, 2 selects Vipers, and 3 selects MiG-29s. In Cold War the corresponding mission templates use period loadouts: F-18C or F-15C with AIM-7, and MiG-29A with R-27ET.

Altitude offset — Feet above the player that the escort attempts to follow. Use 0 for the same altitude or 1,000–10,000 feet in 1,000-foot steps. A high offset gives the fighters room to maneuver but can make close visual formation less obvious.

Escort Takeoff From Ground — ON spawns the escort for a runway departure; OFF airspawns it. Ground takeoff is more immersive but depends on usable parking and runway access at the selected airfield.

2.4.8 Logistics / Warehouse

These settings control two related resources: ready supplies shown in the F10 zone label, and the actual aircraft, weapons, fuel tanks, and miscellaneous warehouse items available for rearming. A supply capacity is an automatic target, not a hard storage limit; player deliveries may raise the stock above it.

Warehouse Logistics — ON uses Foothold's current warehouse-and-zone-supply system. Neutral zones begin without warehouse weapons and must be stocked by players, AI delivery, or automatic refill. Players collect tracked warehouse cargo through the rearming/internal cargo system, not the legacy CTLD or Logistics supply menu. OFF selects the legacy supply workflow.

Neutral Zone Capture Time — Seconds an eligible neutral Foothold zone must remain under a valid capture before ownership changes. Default: 120 seconds; 0 captures immediately. During the timer, the F10 label shows capture progress and the zone tint moves toward the capturing coalition. If every participating troop, cargo, aircraft, or surface group is destroyed or leaves, the capture is cancelled.

Normal Zone Supply Capacity — Sets how many ready Zone Supplies a regular Foothold zone produces automatically before it pauses. Default: 1; choices: 1–3. At full efficiency and Supply Speed Scaling 1.00, each supply takes 20 minutes while the zone has a valid supply route and regular AI logistics is running. [Supplies] 1/1 means one supply is stored and the automatic target is one. Player deliveries may raise the first number above the target.

Warehouse Supply Capacity — Sets the automatic ready-supply target for a Foothold zone marked [WH]. Default: 6; choices: 3–6. At full efficiency and Supply Speed Scaling 1.00, a [WH] zone produces one supply every 10 minutes until it reaches the target. [WH] 3/6 means three supplies are stored and automatic production is working toward six. Player deliveries may raise the first number above six.

CTLD FARP Starting Supplies — Sets the stored supply assigned when a CTLD FARP is built or registered. Default: 1; choices: 1–3. This is starting stock, not a production target: a CTLD FARP does not manufacture replacement supplies. Player deliveries and Add 3 Supplies can increase its stored stock above this value.

Supply Speed Scaling — Uses separate RED and BLUE multipliers for AI supply-mission timers and ready-supply production. Range: 0.10–5.00; default: 1.00. Lower is faster (0.50 halves the time); higher is slower (1.50 adds 50 percent). At 1.00 and full efficiency, a regular Foothold zone takes 20 minutes per supply and a [WH] zone takes 10 minutes. Missing or damaged groups can add up to 10 minutes at normal scale; production waits when no upgrade group is operational. This setting does not change repair, rebuild, or installation time.

Repair Time Scaling — Separate RED and BLUE multipliers for repair, rebuild, and installation after supplies arrive. Range: 0.10–5.00 in 0.05 steps; default: 1.00. 0.50 halves the time; 1.50 adds 50 percent. Production, dispatch, and travel are unchanged. At 1.00, RED has no base delay and adds 1 minute per normal missing unit or 3 minutes per missing SR/TR/STR. BLUE has a 15-minute base in a regular Foothold zone or 5 minutes in a [WH] zone, plus 2 minutes per normal missing unit or 3 minutes per missing SR/TR/STR. Player, CTLD, airdrop, Add 3 Supplies, and Resupply Friendly Zone deliveries skip BLUE's base. Jobs cap at 20 minutes at 1.00.

Extra RED Repair Time With Few Players (ExtraRedRepairTimeLowPlayerCountPercent) — Adds 0–50% to RED repair/build time when fewer than two eligible BLUE CAS players are counted. Default: 0. The extra time is decided when the job starts; it does not change BLUE repairs, supply production, or delivery travel.

Player Zone Supplies Consume Stock — ON removes one ready supply from the departure Foothold zone when a player picks up Zone Supplies. Returning or removing the still-tracked cargo restores that supply; delivering or losing it does not. Carrier and non-stocking dynamic-FARP pickup points remain unlimited. OFF allows player pickups without reducing ready stock.

Use C-130/Chinook Load and Unload — ON uses the C-130J-30 and CH-47 internal or ground-crew cargo systems so Foothold can track warehouse cargo correctly. With Warehouse Logistics enabled, use those aircraft loaders rather than the CTLD load command. OFF disables this integration and is unsuitable when those loaders are required by the mission.

AI Supply Helicopters Use Cargo Transport — ON makes eligible AI warehouse-delivery helicopters carry the tracked external cargo used by the logistics route. OFF keeps the supply flight and stock transfer but uses the non-cargo route logic instead.

Warehouse item delivery and warnings

AI Delivery Amount — Warehouse items added per eligible item type when an AI helicopter supply run succeeds. Default: 20. The same amount is removed from the departure warehouse when the tracked delivery launches. Fixed-wing AI supply uses its own 50-per-item delivery amount. Air-to-ground rockets receive three times the normal addition.

Auto Fill Resources — Automatic background refill added to every active, non-suspended BLUE airbase every 15 minutes. Default: 5 of each eligible warehouse item; air-to-ground rockets receive three times that amount. Setting 0 disables the scheduled refill. Era-restricted and globally forbidden weapons are not added.

Disable Regular BLUE AI Supplies — ON permanently stops regular BLUE AI supply dispatches. It also pauses automatic ready-supply production in regular Foothold zones that depend on BLUE AI logistics; [WH] production remains independent. Player deliveries and shop logistics remain available. ON disables the radio-menu pause setting below.

Radio Menu Stop Supplies — ON adds an AI Logistics control under Stats and Settings so BLUE players can pause or resume regular BLUE AI deliveries during the mission. Pausing also pauses automatic production in regular Foothold zones while preserving stored stock. This control is unavailable when regular BLUE AI supplies are permanently disabled.

Allowed To Carry Supplies — Legacy per-aircraft permission table used only when Warehouse Logistics is OFF. A checked row may use the old Logistics supply menu; an unchecked row may not. With Warehouse Logistics ON, current CTLD/internal-cargo capability decides who can carry supplies, so this table is ignored.

Warn When No Supplies Are Loaded — ON displays the empty-supply warning and plays its reminder sound when a configured supply-capable aircraft takes off without tracked Zone Supplies. OFF disables this reminder without changing cargo permissions.

Takeoff-Warning Aircraft — Per-aircraft list for the empty-supply reminder. Checked means warn this type if it is capable and departs empty; unchecked means stay silent. This list never grants cargo capability. Keep sling-load-only types and the generic Hercules entry OFF when their cargo cannot be detected by the current warehouse workflow.

Smart-weapon refill control

Strict Smart Weapons Inventory — ON halves each warehouse refill addition for weapon identifiers listed below, after any rocket multiplier; fractions are rounded down. OFF gives listed weapons the normal refill amount. This changes replenishment quantity, not what the era allows and not an absolute stock limit.

Warehouse Weapon Caps — The editable list of exact DCS weapon identifiers treated as scarce when Strict Smart Weapons Inventory is ON. Despite the historical name, the table does not contain numeric caps: membership in the list means that each automatic, player, shop, or AI warehouse addition is halved. The default empty list changes nothing.

2.4.9 Shop / Rewards

The shop spends coalition credits on support, missions and zone upgrades. Shop Items combines Item, Available, Price and Rank in one grid. Availability removes or restores an eligible purchase; Price changes its cost and Rank its minimum access level. Items still depend on the mission, Era, templates and game mode. Hidden or locked rows keep their saved preferences; hiding a row alone is not a mission-runtime prohibition.

Advance Capture Threshold % — The highest percentage of an enemy zone's upgrade groups that may remain before Advance Capture becomes available. Default: 50 percent; choices: 20-60 percent. A lower value requires players to destroy more defenders first. Once eligible, the purchased supply force may launch before the zone is fully cleared.

Shop Prices — Coalition-credit cost for each shop item. A value of 0 makes that item free; a higher value only changes the charge, not strength, duration, or quantity. Only items supported by the selected map appear in the shop.

Shop Rank Requirements — Minimum personal rank level required for each item while Ranking System is ON. Rank 1 is the lowest configured gate. With Ranking System OFF, these requirements are not applied. Price and Rank are edited beside the item in the Shop Items grid.

Reward contribution values

Same Aircraft Extra Reward % (TurnaroundRewardPercent) — Default: 10%; range: 0–50%, with 0 disabling the bonus. Redeem a qualifying flight of at least five minutes, then take off again in the same aircraft. Later redemptions receive the configured percentage of eligible contribution as an extra reward while you keep that aircraft. The bonus does not stack; see Section 11.1.

Each value below is the personal contribution added when that event is credited to a player. Contribution is later redeemed into coalition credits and, when enabled, persistent rank progress.

Editable key	Default	Awarded for
infantry	10	An enemy infantry kill.
ground	10	An enemy ground-vehicle kill that is not scored as SAM.
sam	30	An enemy surface-to-air-defence kill.
airplane	50	An enemy fixed-wing aircraft kill.
ship	200	An enemy naval-unit kill.
helicopter	50	An enemy helicopter kill.
crate	100	A qualifying tracked cargo/crate objective.
rescue	200	A completed CSAR rescue event.
structure	100	A qualifying static or structure target.
Zone upgrade	100	A credited friendly-zone upgrade.
Zone capture	200	A credited zone capture.
Warehouse delivery	150	A credited warehouse-cargo delivery.
ctldGround	10	A RED ground unit killed by your deployed CTLD troops or built CTLD units while you remain in a BLUE player aircraft.
ctldAir	20	A RED aircraft killed by your deployed CTLD units while you remain in a BLUE player aircraft.
enemyPilotCapture	200	Each captured enemy pilot delivered to a friendly Foothold zone. Setting 0 disables capture credits, but keeps statistics and debriefing.

Refuel Reward — Contribution awarded for every 100 lb of fuel successfully transferred during an eligible refueling event. Default: 2. The script ignores amounts below its 100 lb accounting step; this is a reward rate, not tanker fuel capacity.

AI Attack Takeoff From Ground — ON makes purchased dynamic attack and support aircraft start from a suitable friendly airbase, then creates their control menu after takeoff. OFF airspawns them above a friendly zone for faster action and fewer parking/runway dependencies.

AI Attack Ground-Takeoff Extra NM — Additional stand-off distance used only by ground-start dynamic flights when selecting a launch area and creating ingress. Default: 40 NM. It gives the flight room to take off, climb, and form up; increasing it can leave fewer valid airbases, while reducing it may push the flight into action too quickly.

Allow Admin Buy — Controls the normal rank-bypass purchase path. Custom mission command words are configured separately under Admin Commands; see Section 13 for setup, examples and the distinction between custom-command mode and default handling.

Allow Scripted Supplies — ON applies supported purchased supply/upgrade actions immediately. OFF sends the normal delivery aircraft or helicopter where the map implements one, so the purchase can be delayed or intercepted before it reaches the target.

2.4.10 CTLD

These settings control the player-carried troop and crate system. The price table decides access, the restore table limits what returns after a restart, and the aircraft table tells the loader what each airframe can physically carry. The values do not change the underlying unit templates in the mission.

CTLD Cost — When enabled, CTLD purchases debit the listed credit cost and enforce the listed minimum rank. When disabled, BLUE and enabled RED CTLD cargo is free; warehouse stock rules can still apply to warehouse items and zone supplies.

Allow RED CTLD — Enables Red logistics in PvE. Caucasus PvP enables it automatically and uses its PvP aircraft and equipment rules; see Section 8.5.

Capture Zone With Engineer — When enabled, an Engineer soldier may capture or upgrade a zone in the same way as regular CTLD troops. When disabled, engineers are not valid capture cargo; regular troop groups still are.

Maximum Saved FARPs — The maximum number of player-built FARPs restored from the previous save. Newer saved FARPs beyond this count are not loaded. A saved FARP is also skipped when the restore safety check places it too far from the current enemy front.

IRIS Restore Unit Health On Merge — Controls what happens when an IRIS-T/HAWK/NASAMS add-on is merged into an existing SAM system during the current session. Off preserves only the units that are still alive and adds the new component. On rebuilds from the full template, so destroyed components can return. This does not change save/load restoration.

CTLD Prices: troops, vehicles, and support

Each row contains a credit price and the minimum personal rank required to request that cargo. Rank 1 is the lowest. Era checks and mission templates can still hide an item even when it remains in this table. Blue and Red labels identify the coalition; standard Blue CTLD items are available in PvE and PvP when the era and mission support them.

Item	Price	Rank	What the item provides
Blue Engineer soldier	50	1	One engineer. Its zone capture/upgrade permission is controlled by Capture Zone With Engineer.
Blue Squad 8	50	1	Eight regular troops that can capture or upgrade an eligible zone.
Blue Platoon 16	100	1	Sixteen regular troops for a larger capture/ground force.
Blue Platoon 32	200	1	Thirty-two regular troops for the largest standard troop load.
Blue Anti-Air Soldiers	100	1	A five-soldier portable air-defence team; not offered in the Vietnam era.
Blue Mortar Squad	100	1	A six-soldier mortar support team.
Blue Mephisto	250	2	A crate-built anti-tank vehicle; not offered in the Vietnam era.
Blue Humvee	250	1	A crate-built anti-tank Humvee group.
Blue Bradly	250	1	A crate-built Bradley anti-tank/infantry fighting vehicle group. The config key intentionally uses this spelling.
Blue L118	150	1	A crate-built L118 artillery group for indirect fire support.
Ammo Truck	100	1	A crate-built ammunition support truck for deployed ground units.
Blue Humvee scout	100	1	A light scout/support vehicle group.
Blue Linebacker	300	2	A mobile short-range air-defence vehicle; not offered in the Vietnam era.
Blue Vulcan	300	2	A mobile gun air-defence vehicle; not offered in the Vietnam era.
Blue FV-107 Scimitar	250	2	A light reconnaissance/support vehicle.
Blue FV-101 Scorpion	250	2	A light armored support vehicle.
Blue Avenger	250	2	A mobile short-range missile air-defence vehicle.

CTLD Prices: SAM systems, FARPs, and heavy support

Item	Price	Rank	What the item provides
Blue HAWK System	750	3	The base HAWK SAM site. Add-ons can expand it or replace a lost component.
Blue Hawk TR Add-on	250	3	One HAWK tracking-radar component to merge into a nearby HAWK site.
Blue Hawk SR Add-on	250	3	One HAWK search-radar component to merge into a nearby HAWK site.
Blue Hawk LN Add-on	250	3	One HAWK launcher component to merge into a nearby HAWK site.
Blue NASAMS System	750	3	The base NASAMS site; available only in the Modern era.
Blue NASAMS C2 Add-on	250	3	One NASAMS command-and-control component for a nearby NASAMS site.
Blue NASAMS SR Add-on	250	3	One NASAMS search-radar component for a nearby NASAMS site.
Blue NASAMS LN Add-on	250	3	One NASAMS launcher component for a nearby NASAMS site.
FARP	500	1	A three-crate player-built FARP. It starts with one zone supply and cannot be packed after construction.
FARP with ZELL	750	1	The alternate three-crate FARP template with ZELL equipment, when that template exists on the map.
Blue IRIS T STR Add-on	750	3	One IRIS-T surveillance/tracking-radar component for a nearby IRIS-T site.
Blue IRIS T LN Add-on	500	3	One IRIS-T launcher component for a nearby IRIS-T site.
Blue IRIS T C2 Add-on	500	3	One IRIS-T command-and-control component for a nearby IRIS-T site.
Blue IRIS T System	1800	3	The three-crate base IRIS-T SAM system.
Blue C-RAM	500	2	A two-crate close-range point-defence system.
Blue HIMARS GMLRRS HE GUIDED	1000	3	A two-crate HIMARS guided-rocket artillery group.

Max At Spawn: restart restoration limits

This table limits how many saved copies of each deployed CTLD item return after the next mission restart. The newest saved entries are kept first; older excess entries are deleted and their stock is returned. A value of 0 means that saved copies of that item are not restored. It does not prevent players from buying or deploying the item during the live session. FARP with ZELL uses the FARP limit.

Saved item	Max	Saved item	Max
Blue Engineer soldier	0	**Blue Mephisto**	2
Blue Humvee	2	**Blue Bradly**	2
Blue L118	3	**Ammo Truck**	3
Blue Humvee scout	1	**Blue Squad 8**	0
Blue Platoon 16	0	**Blue Platoon 32**	0
Blue Anti-Air Soldiers	2	**Blue Mortar Squad**	2
Blue Linebacker	2	**Blue Vulcan**	2
Blue HAWK System	3	**Blue Hawk TR Add-on**	3
Blue Hawk SR Add-on	3	**Blue Hawk LN Add-on**	8
Blue NASAMS System	3	**Blue NASAMS C2 Add-on**	3
Blue NASAMS SR Add-on	3	**Blue NASAMS LN Add-on**	8
Tank Abrahams	0	**FARP (including ZELL)**	3
Blue IRIS T STR Add-on	3	**Blue IRIS T LN Add-on**	8
Blue IRIS T C2 Add-on	3	**Blue IRIS T System**	2
Blue C-RAM	4	**Blue HIMARS GMLRRS HE GUIDED**	4
Blue FV-107 Scimitar	2	**Blue FV-101 Scorpion**	2
Blue Avenger	2		

Tank Abrahams is retained as a legacy save-name entry. Because its value is 0, old saved copies under that name are not restored.

Unit Capabilities: what each aircraft can carry

Each row has six values in the config: whether crates are allowed, whether troops are allowed, the crate limit, the troop limit, an aircraft-length value used by CTLD's load-distance calculation, and the maximum cargo weight. A disabled cargo type remains unavailable even if its numeric limit is above zero. These values are part of the loader's operating assumptions, so unrealistic changes can break loading behavior.

Aircraft type	Crates	Troops	Load length	Max weight
SA342Mistral / L / M / Minigun	No · 0	Yes · 2	10 m	400 kg
UH-1H	Yes · 1	Yes · 8	15 m	800 kg
Mi-8MT	Yes · 3	Yes · 16	15 m	6,000 kg
Mi-8MTV2	Yes · 3	Yes · 18	15 m	6,000 kg
Ka-50 / Ka-50_3	No · 0	No · 0	15 m	400 kg
Mi-24P / Mi-24V	Yes · 2	Yes · 8	15 m	1,000 kg
C-130J-30	Yes · 7	Yes · 64	35 m	21,500 kg
UH-60L / UH-60L_DAP	Yes · 2	Yes · 20	16 m	3,500 kg
AH-64D_BLK_II	No · 0	No · 0	15 m	400 kg
MH-60R	Yes · 2	Yes · 20	16 m	3,500 kg
CH-47Fbl1	Yes · 5	Yes · 32	20 m	10,800 kg
OH58D	No · 0	No · 0	14 m	400 kg

How the CTLD settings work together

Buying and returning cargo — With CTLD Cost enabled, the request is charged only after the rank and credit check passes. Built non-FARP cargo can be packed again; when returned to a friendly load zone, remove crates nearby refunds the purchased sets. Constructed FARPs cannot be packed.

SAM add-ons — A matching add-on merges into a nearby HAWK, NASAMS, or IRIS-T system. This can expand the site or replace a destroyed radar, launcher, or command unit. The IRIS merge toggle above decides whether other destroyed IRIS-T components are also restored during that merge.

FARP stock — Both CTLD FARP variants use the FARP restore limit and start with the configured CTLD supply capacity. When Warehouse Logistics is enabled, their weapon stock follows the CTLD FARP warehouse settings explained in Section 2.4.8.

Troops — Regular troop cargo can capture or upgrade eligible zones. Ground troops close enough (5000 meters) to a zone move toward its center. Extracted troops returned to their original friendly pickup zone are eligible for the CTLD return/refund flow described in the gameplay chapter.

2.4.11 CSAR

CSAR creates recoverable survivors after an ejection. These settings decide which aircraft receive the menu, how many survivors they can carry, how the hover pickup works, how much weight is added, how many survivors remain active or return after a restart, and how often enemy troops may appear near a landing site.

Allowed CSAR Aircraft

The number beside each DCS aircraft type is its maximum survivor capacity. A value of 0 disables the CSAR menu for that type; it is not a zero-seat menu. The type name must match DCS exactly.

Aircraft type	Capacity	Aircraft type	Capacity
Ka-50	0	**Ka-50_3**	0
Mi-24P	8	**SA342Mistral**	3
SA342L	3	**SA342M**	3
SA342Minigun	3	**UH-60L**	11
UH-60L_DAP	11	**AH-64D_BLK_II**	2
UH-1H	11	**Mi-8MT**	24
OH58D	1	**CH-47Fbl1**	32
Bronco-OV-10A	5	**OH-6A**	2
C-130J-30	0	**Hercules**	0
MH-6J	4	**AH-6J**	4
MH-60R	10		

Survivor creation, limits, and weight

Pilot Spawn Without Credits Chance — Chance from 0 to 100 percent that a survivor is created when the ejected player or AI pilot has no credit loss attached. The default 50 means roughly half of those otherwise unrewarded landings still create a rescue target. Set 0 for none or 100 for every eligible landing.

Maximum CSAR At Once — Maximum number of downed-pilot groups kept on the live map. At the default 10, creating an eleventh removes the oldest tracked survivor first. Values below 0 are treated as 0.

Maximum CSAR At Mission Restart — Maximum number of saved survivors restored when the mission starts. The newest saved survivors are restored first, and this value can never restore more than Maximum CSAR At Once. Default: 10.

Pilot Weight — Internal cargo weight added for every survivor onboard. The default is 80 kg per person, so rescuing three survivors adds 240 kg. The weight is cleared when the survivors are dropped off.

Hover-pickup settings

CSAR Hover Distance — Maximum horizontal distance from the survivor for the hover timer to run. Default: 20 m. Moving outside this circle resets the timer.

CSAR Guidance Distance — Horizontal distance where guidance begins. Default: 70 m. The message tells the pilot to move forward, back, left, or right in rounded 5 m steps; if the helicopter is above the height limit it also gives a descend cue.

CSAR Hover Height — Maximum height above ground for pickup. Default: 60 m AGL. The aircraft must also remain at or below 5 m/s while the timer runs.

CSAR Hover Seconds — Continuous time required inside the distance and height limits. Default: 10 seconds. Leaving the pickup conditions cancels the current countdown and the pilot must stabilize again.

Enemy-pilot capture — On supported maps, hover capture uses the configured CSAR distance, height, speed, and time rules. You may also land within 50 m of an enemy pilot to capture him. Enemy pilots do not run to the helicopter from the friendly 650 m pickup radius. See Section 9.4.

Hostile infantry chance

CSAR Hostile Infantry Chance — Chance from 0 to 100 percent that hostile infantry appears around an eligible survivor landing. Default: 25 percent. The check is used for landings outside active zones when an enemy-held active zone is within about 20 NM; configured groups normally appear roughly 0.5-2 NM away. Treat every pickup as potentially hostile.

What the player experiences

Hover pickup — Fly within the guidance area, follow the directional cues, then hold within 20 m, no higher than 60 m AGL, and no faster than 5 m/s for 10 seconds. The survivor boards automatically if the aircraft still has capacity.

Landing pickup — Land within 650 m of the survivor. The survivor runs toward the aircraft and boards inside 20 m; keep the aircraft on the ground while the survivor approaches. These two landing distances are fixed by the mission logic, not by the Config Manager fields above.

Nearby zone and self-recovery — A survivor within 3 NM of a home candidate prefers a BLUE zone or player-built FARP, then a neutral zone, then a RED zone. A nearby BLUE survivor runs home and is recovered within 120 m of the destination. A survivor tied to a neutral or RED zone waits; if that zone becomes BLUE while the survivor is still alive, the survivor returns home. A pilot who lands directly inside a friendly zone is recovered immediately.

Enemy-held zones — Landing in a RED zone does not instantly erase the survivor. The pilot remains a rescue target and may still be collected; if the zone is captured, the home-recovery flow completes. Enemy forces and the hostile-infantry event can still kill or capture the survivor, so do not assume the area is safe.

Credits — When another player boards the survivor, that rescuer receives the normal rescue reward plus the downed player's stored lost credits. The rescuer must then land in any friendly zone to drop off the survivor. If the downed pilot reaches a friendly zone without player pickup—by landing there or running home—the original pilot instead recovers all stored lost credits and the recorded death is removed.

2.4.12 Flight Time

Flight-time rewards give credits for sustained airborne time. The timer is armed at takeoff only for eligible aircraft. A flight must reach five minutes; once it does, those first five minutes count as well. The mission uses completed whole minutes, so 5 minutes 59 seconds pays for 5 minutes.

Reward controls

Reward Flight Time — Master on/off switch. When enabled, eligible takeoffs start a flight-time timer. When disabled, no aircraft earns flight-time credits even if it is enabled in the aircraft table. Current value: enabled.

Flight Time Reward Per Minute — Credits awarded for each completed airborne minute after the five-minute minimum is met. The current value is 2, so a 15-minute eligible flight adds 30 credits. In the landing summary, the number shown beside Flight time is minutes, not credits.

Reward All Aircraft — Chooses whether aircraft type matters. Enabled means every player aircraft is eligible and the table below is ignored. Disabled means only rows marked Enabled in the table can start the timer. Current value: disabled.

Allowed Flight Time Reward — Per-aircraft eligibility table used only while Reward All Aircraft is disabled. Enabled arms the timer when that exact DCS type takes off; Disabled gives that type no flight-time reward. Type names must match DCS exactly.

Current aircraft eligibility

The current config limits this reward to the two supported C-130 cargo types and the CH-47F. Change a row to Enabled to include another type.

Aircraft type	Reward	Aircraft type	Reward
Ka-50	Disabled	**Ka-50_3**	Disabled
Mi-24P	Disabled	**SA342Mistral**	Disabled
SA342L	Disabled	**SA342M**	Disabled
SA342Minigun	Disabled	**UH-60L**	Disabled
UH-60L_DAP	Disabled	**AH-64D_BLK_II**	Disabled
UH-1H	Disabled	**Mi-8MT**	Disabled
OH58D	Disabled	**Bronco-OV-10A**	Disabled
OH-6A	Disabled	**MH-6J**	Disabled
AH-6J	Disabled	**FA-18C_hornet**	Disabled
F-16C_50	Disabled	**F-14B**	Disabled
F-14BU	Disabled	**MiG-29 Fulcrum**	Disabled
C-130J-30	Enabled	**CH-47Fbl1**	Enabled
Hercules	Enabled		

When the credits are paid

Normal landing — After at least five minutes airborne, land in an eligible friendly claim zone and remain there for the normal landing-reward check. The mission converts the completed minutes into credits and records those minutes in the landing statistics.

Ejection — An eligible flight that has already reached five minutes also receives its flight-time credits when the pilot ejects. Flights shorter than five minutes are cleared without a flight-time payment.

2.4.13 Tankers

These two fields set the initial commanded speed for the mission's purchasable dynamic tankers. Arco is the Navy-style drogue tanker; Texaco is the Air Force-style boom tanker. The value is expressed in knots and is converted by the mission for the tanker's altitude.

Texaco Speed — Default speed for the boom tanker. Current value: 286 kt. The config comment notes that the orbit behavior is tuned near 280 kt, which is why 286 is the supplied default.

Arco Speed — Default speed for the drogue tanker. Current value: 286 kt. It uses the same orbit-speed tuning as Texaco.

How the value relates to the tanker menu

The setup file unlocks each tanker through its Shop item and lets the purchaser choose a friendly spawn zone and orbit. Once active, players can use Dynamic Control to select 220, 286, 300, 320, or 340 kt. A menu change becomes the current saved tanker speed and can override the config default after a restart; the config value remains the first-use and fallback speed.

2.4.14 EWRS (Early Warning Radar System)

Enable EWRS (ewrs_enabled) — ON loads EWRS reports and radio menus. OFF disables the service. This is a startup setting: save the config and restart the mission for it to take effect. Default: ON.

EWRS builds an air picture from the coalition's actual radar network. Terrain masking, low altitude, beaming, destroyed radar units, and newly built radar units can therefore change what it detects. Config Manager sets the mission defaults and the choices available to players; each player group can then save its own display choices through Radio menu > Others > Stats and Settings > EWRS.

Report format and range

Default Report Style — Starting format for a new group. Style 1 is the classic multi-line report. Style 2 is the compact format with separator lines and a Merged warning at very short range. Current value: Style 2. Players can change the style in Group Settings.

Maximum Range KM — Highest metric distance offered in the detection-range menu. Current value: 150 km, so the menu offers 10, 20, 40, 60, 80, 100, and 150 km. This is a report filter, not extra radar power: contacts still need to be detected by the radar network.

Maximum Range NM — Highest imperial distance offered in the detection-range menu. Current value: 100 NM, so the menu offers 5, 10, 20, 40, 60, 80, and 100 NM. Lowering the ceiling removes the longer choices from every group's menu.

Default Aircraft Range Limit — Starting report radius for fixed-wing groups, using the default measurement system. Current value: 60, which means 60 NM with the current imperial default. A value above the configured maximum is automatically reduced to that maximum.

Default Helicopter Range Limit — Starting report radius for helicopter groups. Current value: 20, which means 20 NM with the current imperial default. The shorter default keeps a helicopter picture focused on nearby threats.

Message timing, units, and BRA reference

Message Update Interval — Intended delay between automatic picture updates. Current value: 20 seconds. In the present EWRS runtime, the automatic scheduler is fixed at 20 seconds, so changing this field does not yet change the live interval.

Message Display Time — How long each EWRS report or settings confirmation stays on screen. Current value: 15 seconds. This does not change how often a new automatic picture is produced.

Restrict to One Reference — When enabled, removes the player's Own aircraft/Bullseye reference choice. The Default Reference below then becomes compulsory. Current value: disabled, so groups may choose either reference.

Default Reference — Starting point used for bearing and range. Self-measures from the requesting aircraft; Bulls measures from the coalition bullseye. Current value: Self. Bogey Dope always uses the requesting aircraft even if the group normally uses Bullseye.

Default Measurements — Starting unit system. Imperial reports feet, knots, and NM; Metric reports meters, km/h, and km. Current value: Imperial. A player can change units in Group Settings or by choosing a KM/NM detection range; the group's current range is converted when the unit system changes.

Who receives reports and how they are delivered

Default Show Tankers — Starting tanker-contact toggle for new groups. Current value: disabled. BLUE groups can enable it under Friendlies to add the mission's active Texaco, Arco, and Shell tankers to the picture.

Enable RED Team — Allows RED player groups to receive EWRS menus and reports. Current value: enabled. Disabling it removes EWRS service for RED players only.

Enable BLUE Team — Allows BLUE player groups to receive EWRS menus and reports. Current value: enabled. Disabling it removes EWRS service for BLUE players only.

Disable Message When No Threats — When enabled, automatic cycles stay quiet if the radar network has no reportable hostile contact. Current value: enabled. It does not suppress the result of a player-requested on-demand picture.

On Demand — Changes EWRS from recurring pictures to player requests. Disabled gives groups automatic pictures and an Auto Picture toggle. Enabled stops the recurring reports and adds a Request Picture command. Current value: disabled.

Threats, friendlies, and displayed detail

Maximum Threat Display — Default number of hostile contacts listed in each picture. Current value: 5. Zero means all detected threats. Players can choose 1–5 or All from Threat limit; this shortens or lengthens the report but does not change detection.

Allow Bogey Dope — Permits a closest-threat report that always uses the requesting aircraft as the reference. Current value: enabled. In the present menu, the command appears when On Demand is enabled or when that group has turned Auto Picture off.

Allow Friendly Picture — Loads the friendly-picture feature switch. Current value: enabled. The current F10 menu does not wire a separate Friendly Picture request command; friendly contacts are instead added to the normal picture with the Friendlies toggle.

Maximum Friendly Display — Default number of non-tanker friendly aircraft included when Friendlies is on. Current value: 3. Zero means all friendly aircraft, although the current player menu offers 1–5 as its selectable limits.

Show Type — Enabled reports the aircraft's recognized type name. Disabled replaces the type with Unknown while still reporting bearing, range, altitude, aspect, and speed. Current value: enabled.

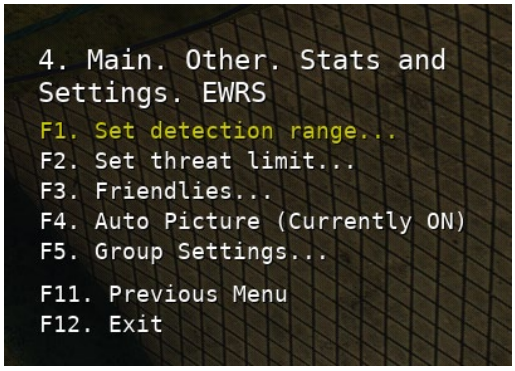
Merged Range NM — Style 2 only. A hostile contact closer than this raw distance receives a Merged warning. Current value: 5 NM. Set it to 0 to disable the warning.

Special aircraft defaults

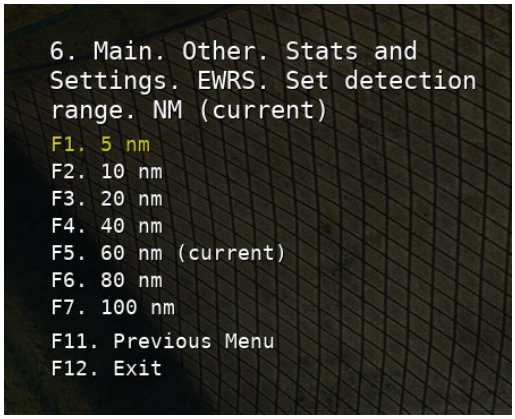
Special Plane Types — Aircraft type names that begin with Show Friendlies enabled when a new group is created. The current rows are F-4E-45MC, MiG-29 Fulcrum, F-5E-3_FC, and C-130J-30. Players in those aircraft can still turn Friendlies off, and other aircraft can turn it on.

Player menu examples

The menu marks the group's current choices. These are personal group settings: changing them does not alter the mission-wide Config Manager defaults for other groups.



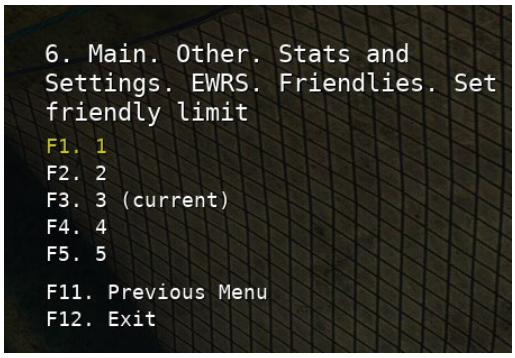
Main EWRS controls: range, threat limit, friendlies, Auto Picture, and group settings.



Choosing an NM value also makes that group use imperial report units.



Friendly aircraft and tanker contacts can be shown independently.



Friendly limit controls how many nearby friendly aircraft are listed.

2.4.15 AIEN (Ground AI Enhancement)

AIEN makes eligible ground groups react to combat instead of remaining static. Depending on the situation, units may deploy smoke, seek cover, disperse, suppress enemies, dismount infantry, request or provide fire support, or make a limited advance. Foothold keeps these reactions tied to the mission's zone and coalition rules. The controls below decide whether AIEN starts, which sides use it, which optional behaviors are allowed, and how often its work queues are processed.

Enablement and coalition controls

Do Not Initialize — Master startup switch. Disabled means AIEN starts automatically with the mission, which is the normal Foothold setting. Enable it only when another mission script will start AIEN manually; otherwise AIEN is loaded but none of its processing begins. Current value: disabled.

BLUE AI — Applies AIEN reactions and initiative to eligible BLUE ground groups. Turning it off leaves those groups under normal DCS AI control and suppresses their AIEN action messages; it does not remove the units. Current value: enabled.

RED AI — Same coalition-wide control for RED ground groups. Turning it off stops AIEN reactions, initiative decisions, and AIEN action messages for RED while leaving the groups in the mission. Current value: enabled.

Optional AI behavior

Dismount — Allows infantry-carrying ground vehicles—mainly trucks, APCs, and IFVs—to deploy rifle, RPG, and sometimes MANPADS teams when appropriate. A hit from an aircraft can trigger a MANPADS dismount; a nearby ground attacker can trigger a troop dismount. This creates extra groups and can cost performance on busy missions. Current value: enabled.

Message Feed — Shows coalition messages when relevant AIEN actions begin, such as a reaction, artillery task, counter-battery response, or an initiative move. Turning it off hides these reports but does not stop the behavior itself. Current value: enabled.

Initiative — Lets eligible untasked MBT, ATGM, IFV, APC, and reconnaissance groups make a short independent advance when their own sensors have identified a weaker nearby enemy and the terrain permits movement. It does not give every group permission to roam: groups under attack, already tasked, excluded by mission rules, or beyond the range limit are skipped. Current value: enabled. The initiative phase is intentionally skipped on the Kola map.

Processing cadence

These three values are delays in seconds between small pieces of AIEN work. A higher value spreads the work out and can reduce CPU spikes, but reactions and database updates may take longer. Leave the defaults unless AIEN is causing performance problems; if tuning is needed, change Active first, then Idle, and use Minimum only for a startup spike.

Minimum Phase Timer — Initialization cadence while AIEN builds its databases. Current value: 0.20 seconds. Raise it to roughly 0.30–0.50 only if mission startup produces a noticeable processing spike.

Active Phase Timer — Main runtime cadence while an AIEN queue still has work waiting. Current value: 0.04 seconds. Raising it to roughly 0.06–0.08 reduces how aggressively AIEN processes pending work, with a small delay in reactions and updates.

Idle Phase Timer — Relaxed cadence when the AIEN queues are empty. Current value: 0.50 seconds. Raise it to roughly 0.80–1.00 if idle scheduler activity is still a concern; this mainly affects how quickly AIEN notices new work after a quiet period.

2.4.16 Aircraft / Weapons

This page controls warehouse aircraft and weapon availability. In PvE, Modern uses the normal DCS aircraft inventory and optional mod restocking; Coldwar/Gulfwar and Vietnam use their existing Blue aircraft list. In PvP, historical eras use one shared list unless separate coalition lists are enabled, while Modern shows a Blue/Red pair only with that option enabled. Weapon-restriction lists apply to both coalitions. Aircraft required by enabled AI features remain protected; select the row and follow its Here links to change the feature first.

How the Active and Available lists work

Active — The item is inside the live Lua table. For an allowed-aircraft list, Active means the aircraft is stocked and permitted. For a restricted or forbidden-weapon list, Active means the weapon is removed. The same word therefore has opposite results depending on the list's purpose.

Available / Commented — The item remains in the config as a disabled example but is not applied. Use the arrow buttons to move an entry between the two sides. Add Item creates a new row; use the exact DCS internal aircraft or weapon type name because a display name or spelling variation will not match the warehouse item.

Aircraft availability lists

Allowed Aircraft — BLUE warehouse aircraft for Coldwar and Gulfwar. When the warehouse is synchronized, aircraft not in this Active list are set to zero and every listed type is stocked as effectively unlimited. This does not install a module or mod; the aircraft must already exist on the server and client.

Allowed RED Aircraft — Historical Red/neutral warehouse settings remain separate from the active PvP choices. In PvP use the visible shared list or the visible Blue/Red pair for the selected Era; do not edit a second hidden legacy list to configure the same side.

Vietnam Allowed Aircraft — BLUE warehouse aircraft for the Vietnam era. Only the Active type names are stocked when a BLUE warehouse is synchronized. Use this list to keep later aircraft out of a Vietnam-era mission while allowing selected community modules or variants.

Vietnam Allowed RED Aircraft — PvP Vietnam uses either one shared list or one Blue/Red pair, selected by Different aircraft per coalition. PvE keeps its existing Blue Vietnam list. Hidden compatibility values remain saved.

WW2 aircraft — The Normandy config has separate BLUE (AllowedWW2Planes) and RED (AllowedWW2RedPlanes) warehouse aircraft lists. Each coalition can use its own allowed types; the type must still exist in DCS and the mission.

Mods Aircraft List — Additional aircraft types that Foothold refills for Modern-era warehouse use when Mission options > Allow Mods is enabled. Add only modules installed on both the server and the players' clients. The list stocks the aircraft; it does not create player slots or install the mod.

Weapon-removal lists

Cold War Restricted Weapons — Weapons removed from Coldwar and Gulfwar warehouses. Active entries are forced out during warehouse setup and later restocks. Move an entry to Available / Commented to permit it again, provided the item is otherwise present or restocked by the mission.

Vietnam Restricted Weapons — Same control for Vietnam warehouses. It normally removes later missiles, guided weapons, pods, and other items that do not fit the selected mission. It does not affect Modern unless the same item is also in Forbidden Weapons All Eras.

Forbidden Weapons All Eras — Global hard-ban list applied after the era rules. Every Active item is forced to zero in Modern, Coldwar, Gulfwar, and Vietnam and is excluded from refills and copied warehouse stock. The default Active entries are the RN-24 and RN-28 nuclear bombs. Move an item out of Active only when it is intentionally allowed in every era where it would otherwise be available.

Practical rule: use the allowed-aircraft lists to decide what can spawn from an era warehouse, the era restricted-weapon list to shape that era's technology, and Forbidden Weapons All Eras only for items that must never be supplied. Section 2.3 shows the list controls and the linked era update visually.

2.4.17 F10 Map

These options change only how the Foothold supply connections are drawn on the F10 map. They do not add or remove routes, change capture order, or alter how supplies move. Connection markings are redrawn as zone ownership changes.

Connection Display — Choose Arrows to show the direction of each supply connection, or Lines to draw a thicker dashed route without an arrowhead. Current value: Lines. Use Arrows when route direction is important; use Lines when a less cluttered overview is preferred.

Connection Color — Choose Dynamic to color a route BLUE when it starts from BLUE and does not end at RED, RED when it starts from RED and does not end at BLUE, and white for neutral or mixed connections. Choose White to draw every route white regardless of ownership. Current value: Dynamic.

2.4.18 Settings locked while PvP is enabled

The Manager locks controls that the current Caucasus PvP rules do not use. Locked controls keep their stored values for a later PvE session; a lock does not overwrite your saved preference. Some shop and CTLD rows are hidden when their mode or Era is inapplicable. Use the visible controls described below.

Chance AI Attack Helo — The original PvE setting is locked in PvP. Use PvP settings > PvP Chance AI Attack Helo for the chance applied to the affected air missions on both coalitions. Invisible A-10 still takes precedence.

CAP, CAS, SEAD and Runway difficulty; Friendly CAP/CAS/SEAD Support — These automatic role selectors and their advanced per-role stage tables are locked in PvP. Use PvP Combat AI Group Limit for the shared per-coalition fixed-wing allowance. The tables retain their values and become editable again in PvE.

Disable Regular Blue AI Supplies and Radio Menu Stop Supplies — These Blue-only PvE controls are locked in PvP. Use PvP AI Supplies to control automatic deliveries for both sides. Paid logistics remains separate.

Enable Hunter, Red Enemy Strike Plane Templates and Extra Red Repair Time — Low Player Count % — These older one-sided event/recovery controls are locked in PvP. Their stored settings remain available for PvE.

PVE Only and Remove Southern Syria — These controls do not apply to Caucasus PvP and are locked there. PvP permits both coalitions to play; it does not use the Syria-only map-removal setting.

Max Saved FARPs — PvP uses its existing limit of three active FARPs per coalition, so the PvE total-save setting is locked. CTLD Items > Max saved still describes saved equipment retention, not a live purchase cap.

Escort controls — When PvP Escorts is off, the affected escort aircraft table and ground-takeoff control are locked. Enable PvP Escorts before customizing those controls for PvP.

Shared settings remain editable when they still matter. Prices and rank requirements, the aircraft-count ignore lists, Director intelligence options and Red Reactive Difficulty are not blanket-disabled just because PvP is selected. Follow each field's help and the visible mode-specific controls.

2.5 Ranking System

Foothold has a ranking system which tracks what you have earned so far. This is a separate save file called Foothold_Ranks.lua. This ranking file does not reset and will be used on every Foothold mission.

The ranking system adds all the credits you have earned and gives you a title based on how much you have earned. By increasing your rank, you get access to more shop items.

Rank Titles

Rank	Title	Total Earned	Increase
0	Recruit	0	-
1	Aviator	3,000	+3,000
2	Airman	5,000	+2,000
3	Senior Airman	8,000	+3,000
4	Staff Sergeant	12,000	+4,000
5	Technical Sergeant	16,000	+4,000
6	Master Sergeant	22,000	+6,000
7	Senior Master Sergeant	30,000	+8,000
8	Chief Master Sergeant	45,000	+15,000
9	Second Lieutenant	65,000	+20,000
10	First Lieutenant	90,000	+25,000
11	Captain	120,000	+30,000
12	Major	155,000	+35,000
13	Lieutenant Colonel	195,000	+40,000
14	Colonel	240,000	+45,000
15	Brigadier General	290,000	+50,000
16	Major General	345,000	+55,000
17	Lieutenant General	405,000	+60,000
18	General	470,000	+65,000
19	General of the Air Force	540,000	+70,000

You can see your ranking in the welcome message when spawning, or use the radio menu: F10 > Others > Stats and Budget > Stats > My Stats. You can also see other players' stats by selecting All Stats.

To change what is available at each rank, open Config Manager > Shop / Rewards and edit the rank requirements.

2.6 RED Reactive Counterpressure

RED Reactive Counterpressure is automatic. It controls how RED reacts when BLUE puts pressure near RED frontline zones.

- Soft reaction: RED speeds up supply and CAP responses.
- Hard reaction: RED can force attack groups to push back.

Its behavior follows the mission's selected difficulty profile; there are no separate advanced counterpressure fields to edit.

2.7 Mods Support

In Foothold Config Manager, open Mission options and enable Allow Mods. Then complete the warehouse EQP setup in Section 2.2 so mod equipment is stocked at the required airfields and FARPs.

In the Mission Editor warehouse, select EQP, choose All, enter 10000, use Fill Col, and copy the settings to all airfields and FARPs. The final warehouse screenshot in Section 2.2 shows these controls.

> **Warning**
> Do NOT select A/C, otherwise all the neutral airbases will also be dynamic spawn enabled which is not intended!

3. Warehouse Logistics

Foothold uses Warehouse Logistics by default. When an enemy zone is neutralized, its weapon, missile, bomb, rocket, and equipment stock is not inherited. To change this behavior, open Foothold Config Manager > Logistics / Warehouse. The Manager also explains stock, pickup, AI delivery, autofill, and supply-speed settings; see Section 2.4.

> **Starting Zone**
> The first homebase is marked [WH]. Its aircraft, fuel, and weapon/equipment warehouse stock is unlimited while the warehouse is operational; this is separate from ready Zone Supplies. A [WH] zone produces supplies up to Warehouse Supply Capacity (6 by default), and player deliveries may exceed that target. Build another Logistics Center at an eligible fully upgraded friendly airbase through the shop (5,000 credits and Rank 1 by default).

3.1 Zone Supplies vs Warehouse Items

To capture a neutral Foothold zone or upgrade a friendly one, deliver Zone Supplies from a friendly Foothold zone or CTLD zone to the destination.

There are 2 types of categories you can carry:

- Zone Supplies — used to capture or upgrade a Foothold zone.
- Warehouse Items — used to increase the weapons stock in the airbase.

Zone supplies by themselves carry 10 of everything: A/A Missiles, A/G Guided bombs, A/G Missiles, A/G Rockets, A/G Bombs, Fuel tanks, and Misc. (like targeting pods).

Warehouse items will only increase the number of weapons. Each cargo has its own weight. Each aircraft has its own weight limitation, found inside the CTLD menu under 'List loaded cargo'.

Warehouse warning labels

A/A — air-to-air missiles; **A/G** — air-to-ground missiles; **RKT** — air-to-ground rockets.

TNK — aircraft fuel tanks; **G-B** — guided bombs; **U-B** — unguided bombs.

Low-stock warnings — one low category is written in full. Two or three low categories use the abbreviations above. Larger shortages show LOW WAREHOUSE, while a broadly depleted warehouse shows EMPTY WAREHOUSE.

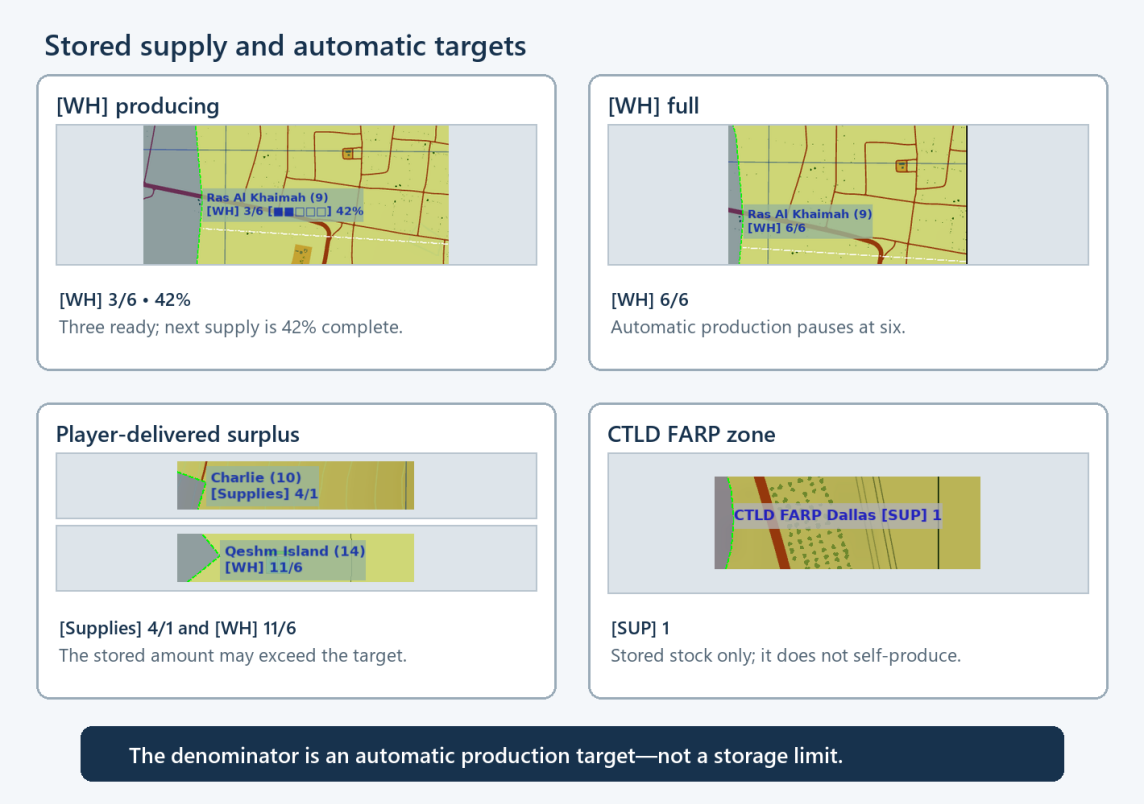
Plane fuel tanks and pylons — this CTLD warehouse cargo replenishes fuel tanks together with related pylons and miscellaneous equipment.

Reading F10 supply labels

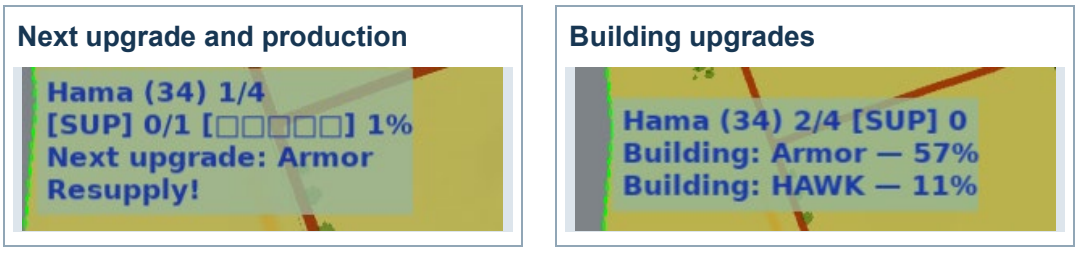
Friendly Foothold zones and CTLD zones show supply information beside their names. The label identifies stored ready supplies, the automatic target, next-supply progress, built groups, recovery work, and whether more stock is required.
Zone status — Ras Al Khaimah (9) 3/4 means waypoint 9 and three of four upgrade groups are currently built.
[WH] — Marks a warehouse Foothold zone with a functioning Logistics Center. Its automatic ready-supply target is six by default. At Supply Speed Scaling 1.00 and full efficiency, it produces one ready supply every 10 minutes.
Next-supply progress — the five-cell bar and percentage show progress toward the next ready supply. Lower Supply Speed Scaling is faster and higher is slower. Missing or damaged groups add production delay, and production pauses when no upgrade group is operational.

Building, Repairing, and Training — Each active job names the group and shows its progress, for example Building: Armor — 57%. Infantry repairs are labelled Training. Up to two recovery jobs can run at once. Each completed job consumes one stored supply, and progress survives a mission restart. Resupply! means more ready stock is needed before all remaining work can finish. Repair Time Scaling controls timing; see Section 2.4.8.
CTLD zone [SUP] 1 — a newly built or registered CTLD FARP starts with CTLD FARP Starting Supplies (default 1). This is stored stock only: a CTLD zone does not self-produce. Players must deliver replacement or surplus supplies.
Regular Foothold zone [Supplies] 1/1 — one ready supply is stored and the automatic target is one. At Supply Speed Scaling 1.00 and full efficiency, the zone produces one supply every 20 minutes while its route and BLUE AI logistics are active. During production the label shows [SUP] and progress; when full or paused it shows [Supplies].
While a group is building or repairing, the label keeps the waypoint and upgrade count, then places [WH] where applicable and [SUP] with the stored amount on the first line. With no active job, supplies return to their normal position. Next upgrade names the next missing group. Friendly Zone Status, including the status map-marker command, also lists missing upgrades and groups needing repair.

Player-delivered surplus — players can bring supplies from other Foothold zones or CTLD zones and raise a [WH], regular Foothold zone, or CTLD zone above its automatic target. The denominator is a production target, not a storage limit.



Automatic targets: [WH] Foothold zones stop at six, regular Foothold zones stop at one, CTLD zones do not self-produce, and player deliveries may exceed either target.



Next upgrade and supply production (left); compact supply stock and two named building jobs (right).

Warehouse buildings and repairs

A Logistics Center has a physical warehouse building. Its destruction removes the [WH] benefits: ready-supply capacity returns to the normal-zone target and unlimited weapon stock is lost. The label reports [WH destroyed]. The building state and repair progress are saved between sessions.

Use Shop > Capture & resources > Repair Logistic Center at an eligible friendly zone with a destroyed warehouse. Repair takes 30 minutes; the label shows its progress. When complete, the building and Logistics Center benefits return. The default price is 2,000 credits; the map and configuration control availability.



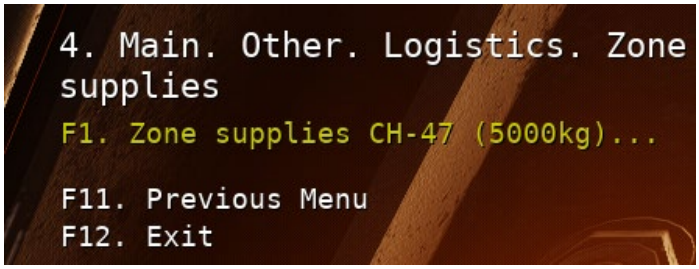
The warehouse building is a separate target from the zone's defensive upgrade groups.

3.2 Loading and Unloading Cargo

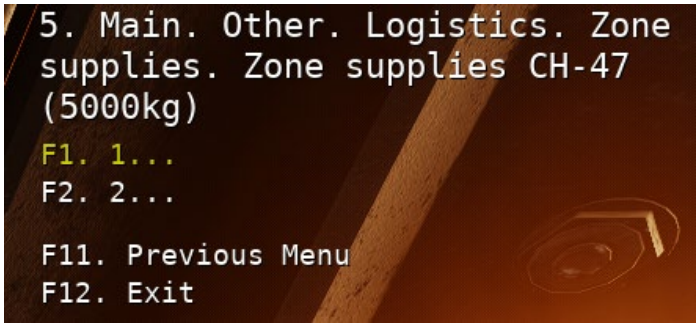
Picking Up Zone Supplies

Radio menu > Others > Logistics > Zone Supplies. Based on your aircraft, you will see the name and cargo weight.

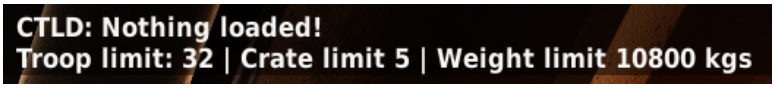
You may be able to pick up 2 or more cargoes depending on your aircraft's weight limit.



Choose Zone Supplies from the Logistics radio menu.



Select the number of supplies to pick up.



Check the aircraft cargo weight limit before loading.

Loading Cargo

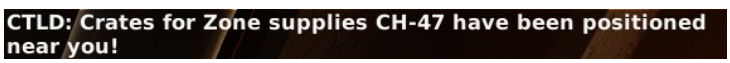
> **IMPORTANT: Use Rearming Menu Only!**
> To load cargo, use the Rearming menu and nothing else. Do NOT use the CTLD menu to load these items (even if you see 'get and load'). Using CTLD will make the cargo disappear and it will NOT be tracked at all.

Open the cargo door, then open the rearming menu. Select 'Cargo' with the arrow up. Select items one at a time, then select Load.

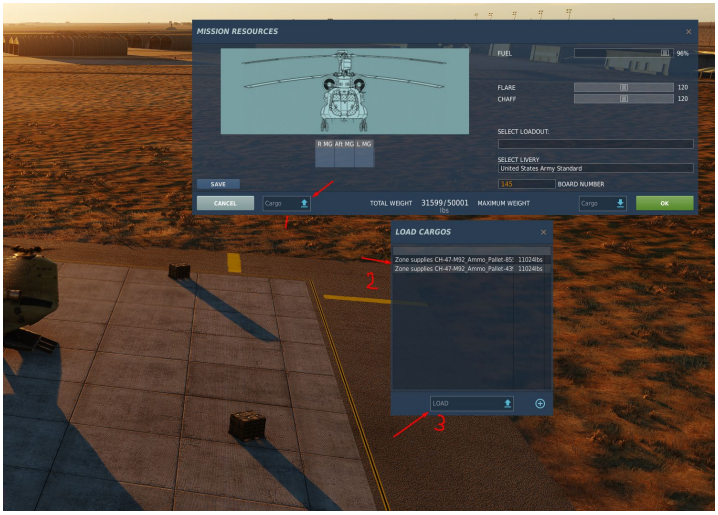
Be aware of your weight — the cargo weight limit is still valid. With 100% fuel, you'll probably be overweight. Lower your fuel or carry less.



Zone supply crates are staged near the aircraft.



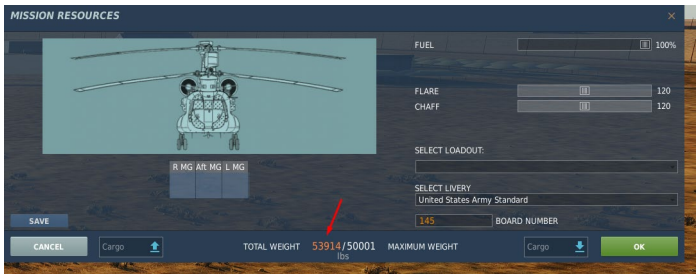
Foothold confirms that the crates are ready to load.



Use the rearming Cargo panel to load staged supplies.



Ground crew confirms each loaded supply crate.

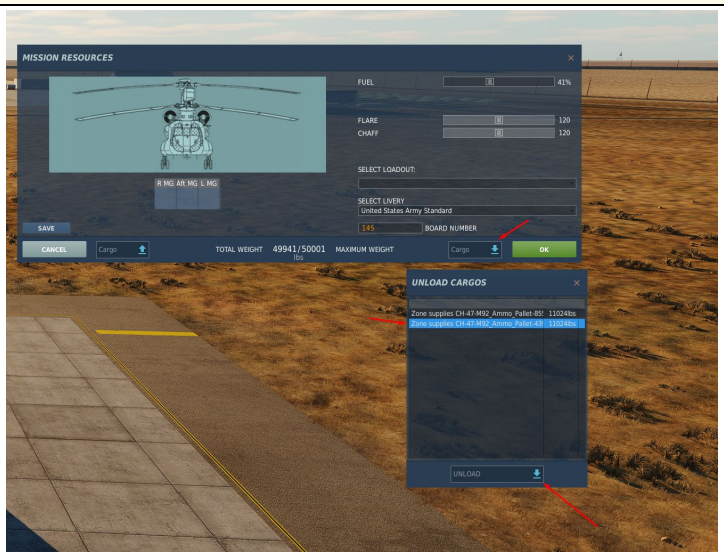


If cargo exceeds the aircraft limit, reduce fuel or carry less.

Unloading Cargo

To unload: land inside the zone, open the rearming menu and select Unload. Don't forget to open the cargo door! After a few seconds, a message will confirm the cargo has been unloaded and the base will be captured or upgraded.

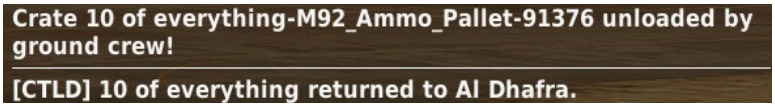
> **Tip**
> If you take warehouse items and regret that decision, load then unload them using the rearming menu. They will be removed and the items will return to the warehouse. This only works for warehouse items.



Select the cargo in the rearming menu and choose Unload.



Unloaded zone supplies capture or upgrade the destination.



Unloaded warehouse items are returned to the destination stock.

3.3 C-130J-30 Operations

The C-130J-30 plays a big role. You can carry both zone supplies and warehouse items, load many more warehouse items and carry up to 4 zone supplies. Bringing 4 zone supplies will capture/upgrade the zone and add 40 of every item in the warehouse.

You can also load regular CTLD items (FARP, SAM system, truck, or units) and airdrop them. Normally you need to drop an engineer, but in Foothold items are built automatically when airdropped from the air. Auto build only happens if you're in the air — on the ground, dropping items will still require manual build from the CTLD menu.

Loading in C-130

- Open the C-130 Checklist. Make sure the rear cargo door is open.
- Select 'STAGE NEARBY' to stage cargo.
- Select cargo in the bottom panel or upper corner.
- Switch to Loadmaster view and walk inside the plane to the rear before loading.
- Select 'Load staged'. Increase parachute count for heavy cargo (~5 for 11-ton items).

1. Prepare the load

Assign enough parachutes for every heavy item, including zone supplies, warehouse items, FARPs, and IRIS-T components.

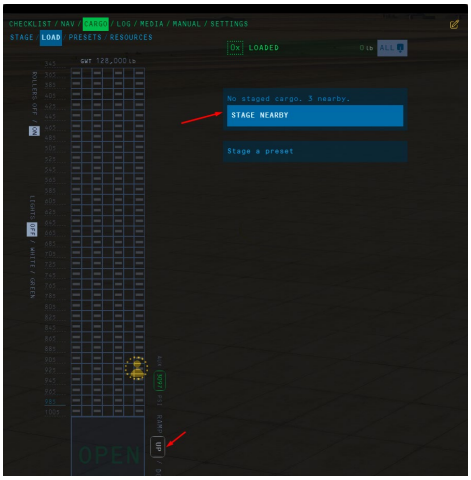
Distance Warning
If the dropped items end up with a distance greater than 2000 meters between each other, they will NOT be built. If cargo lands on a house, it will not be auto built either.



Stage nearby cargo with the rear cargo door open.



Before loading: select the cargo and assign the required parachutes.



Select the cargo and use Load staged.



Ground crew confirms the loaded C-130 cargo.

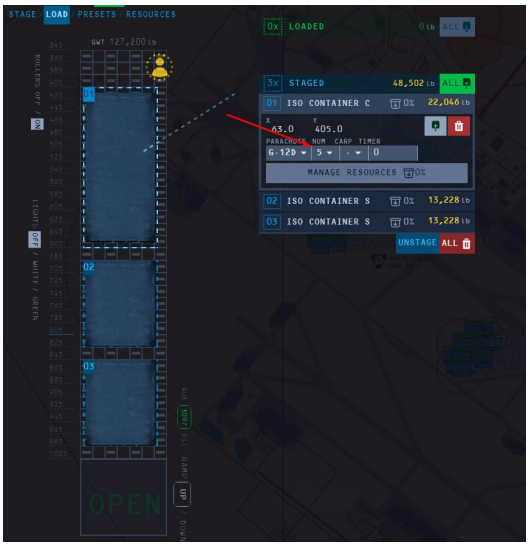


After loading: crates are visible in the C-130 cargo compartment.

3.4 Airdrop

1. Stabilize the aircraft

Fly straight and level, slow down until the HUD W symbol is about 6-7 degrees, then unlock the cargo.



Fly straight and level during the airdrop.



Keep the C-130 stable and monitor the cargo during release.

2. Release inside the destination

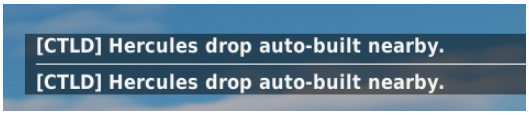
Drop zone supplies and warehouse items inside the destination zone. Keep all required items within 2,000 m of one another.



C-130 airdrop with parachutes.

3. Confirm the build

After about 30 seconds, eligible CTLD cargo auto-builds. Cargo that lands on a house must be built manually.



Dropped CTLD cargo auto-builds nearby.



Legacy supply delivery at a destination zone.

3.5 Supply Missions, Production, and Recovery

Zone Supplies are stored separately from an airbase's weapons and equipment. Foothold zones consume this ready stock for local repair or upgrade work, and players can collect it for delivery elsewhere. The F10 label in Section 3.1 shows the stored amount, production progress, and active recovery work.

Automatic production — At Supply Speed Scaling 1.00, a regular Foothold zone makes one ready supply every 20 minutes and a [WH] Foothold zone makes one every 10 minutes. Production stops at the configured automatic target, not a storage limit. Missing or damaged upgrade groups slow production, but the added delay is capped at 10 minutes. Production pauses when no upgrade group is operational.
Supply Speed Scaling — RED and BLUE have separate multipliers for automatic production and AI supply-mission timers. 1.00 is normal, 0.50 takes half the normal time, and 1.50 takes 50% longer. This setting does not change repair, installation, or aircraft travel time.
Player collection and surplus — Player-delivered stock may exceed the automatic target. When Player Zone Supplies Consume Stock is enabled, a pickup removes one ready package from the source Foothold zone. Returning or removing that cargo restores the package; destroying or delivering it does not. The Add 3 Supplies shop item can add stock to either a Foothold zone or a CTLD zone.
AI supply missions — After a Foothold zone is captured or upgraded, AI logistics can bring warehouse resources from a departure zone. A run adds the configured AI Delivery Amount to every resource category (20 by default). BLUE zones also receive Auto Fill Resources on a 15-minute timer (five of each category by default). Existing BLUE AI deliveries keep their normal direct-upgrade behavior after arrival.
Local recovery — A Foothold zone can run up to two repairs, rebuild, or installation jobs at once. Each local BLUE job consumes one stored supply. Repairs and upgrades appear on separate label lines, and damaged-group health is shown until that repair begins.
BLUE time at normal scaling — Work started with self-produced stock has a 15-minute base at a regular Foothold zone or a 5-minute base at a [WH] Foothold zone, plus 2 minutes for each missing normal unit or 3 minutes for each missing SR, TR, or STR unit. Player, CTLD, airdrop, Add 3 Supplies, and Resupply Friendly Zone deliveries skip the base time and apply only the missing-unit time.
RED time at normal scaling — RED begins recovery after a supply delivery and therefore has no additional base time: each missing normal unit adds 1 minute and each missing SR, TR, or STR unit adds 3 minutes. A repair or installation is capped at 20 minutes. If a SAM is completely destroyed while its repair is active, that job is cancelled and another supply delivery is required.
Repair Time Scaling — RED and BLUE use separate multipliers after supplies is available. 1.00 uses the times above, 0.50 takes half as long, and 1.50 takes 50% longer. The 20-minute maximum is scaled too. This setting does not change production, dispatch, or travel time.
Saved progress and Resupply! — Ready stock, production progress, CTLD zone stock, and active recovery work retain their remaining state after a mission restart. Resupply! appears when a BLUE Foothold zone lacks enough ready stock for its remaining work; its resupply mission remains active until the zone has enough supplies.

3.6 Legacy Supplies (WarehouseLogistics = false)

If WarehouseLogistics is set to false, the legacy supply system applies. Players in helicopters or C-130 can carry supplies. Each supply will upgrade or repair one group. If the zone is neutral, it will capture that zone.

Radio menu > Others > Logistics > Load Supplies. Then fly to the target zone and select 'Unload Supplies'.

Both BLUE and RED use ground convoys and helicopters for supply; helicopters perform most deliveries. Select eligible supply aircraft in Config Manager > Mission Rules.



load, unload, list zones, and check status.

4. Overview, Spawning and Zones

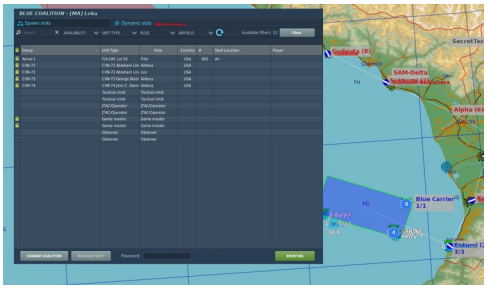
4.1 F10 Map Overview

When you load in the mission, you'll see the coalition select window, then a spawn window. Make sure you select Dynamic spawn. You can then either select the place to spawn from the F10 map (click on the airbase symbol) or select from the list.

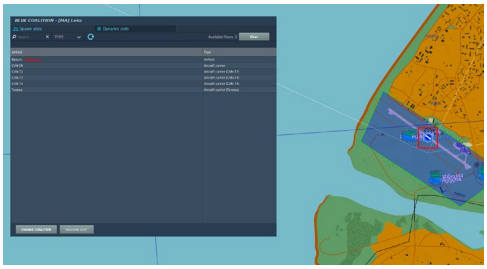
4.2 Spawning

When spawning, you'll receive a welcome message with the latest ATIS (Automatic Terminal Information Service) and what runway is in use. On carriers, you get the BRC instead.

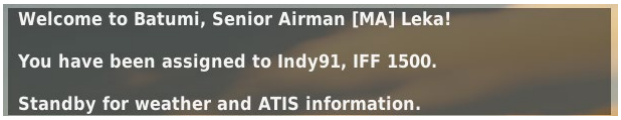
Popular modules such as the F-16, F/A-18, and AH-64 receive an automatic callsign when they spawn (for example, Indy91). Additional players at the same airbase receive the next flight number. Administrators can edit the displayed callsigns and optional LotATC IFF codes in Config Manager > Welcome Message Callsigns; there is no in-game Change Call Sign menu.



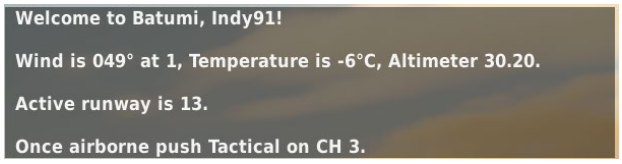
Choose Dynamic spawn and select a spawn point.



Select an airfield on the F10 map or from the list.



The welcome message assigns rank, callsign, and IFF.



The welcome message shows ATIS and the active runway.

Communication
'Once airborne Push Tactical on CH 3' — Switch to Channel 3 when airborne for tactical comms. Communicate on CH 7 while in approach or on the ground. All Fox calls should be made on CH 3 so A-10s don't get scared when they get missile warnings.

4.3 Zones Explained

On the F10 map, each zone shows important information. For example: Batumi (2) 3/3 means the zone name is Batumi, waypoint number 2, and it has 3/3 groups (fully upgraded). If the enemy destroys some units, it becomes e.g. 2/3.

- Friendly zones — show upgrade status (e.g., 3/3).
- Hostile zones — do NOT show how many upgrades are deployed.
- SAM zones (e.g., SAM-Alpha, Incirlik defense) — not designed to be captured (except in Sinai). Defeat the air defenses first.
- Side mission zones — typically don't have waypoint numbers. Coordinates are in the Kneeboard. Cannot be captured; zone turns dark transparent when disabled.
- Neutral zones — intended to be captured.

Timed neutral-zone capture

A valid delivery or capture group now starts a capture timer instead of changing an eligible neutral Foothold zone immediately. The default is 120 seconds; administrators can change Neutral Zone Capture Time under Config Manager > Logistics / Warehouse, or set it to 0 for immediate capture.

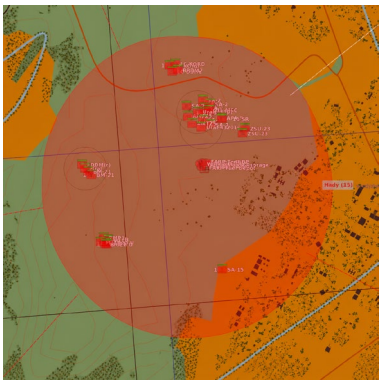
During the timer, the F10 label shows the capture percentage, the zone tint moves toward the capturing coalition, and BLUE receives progress messages. The capture is cancelled if every participating troop, cargo, aircraft, or surface group is destroyed or leaves. Active capture progress survives a mission restart, and additional troops or supplies delivered during the timer become stored zone supplies after capture.

RED Foothold-zone colors

A RED Foothold zone's tint gives a quick indication of what kind of defenders remain:

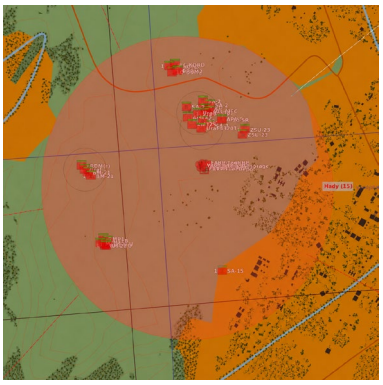
- Red — the zone retains its normal combat state.
- Light red — the damaged zone still has mobile units, but no air-defence units remain.
- Purple — only static structures remain; no mobile defenders remain.

Normal combat



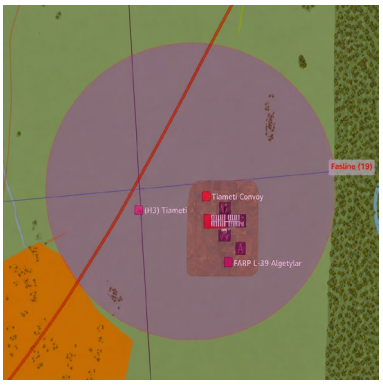
Red - air defences and other mobile defenders remain.

No working air defence



Light red - mobile defenders remain, but no air-defence units are operational.

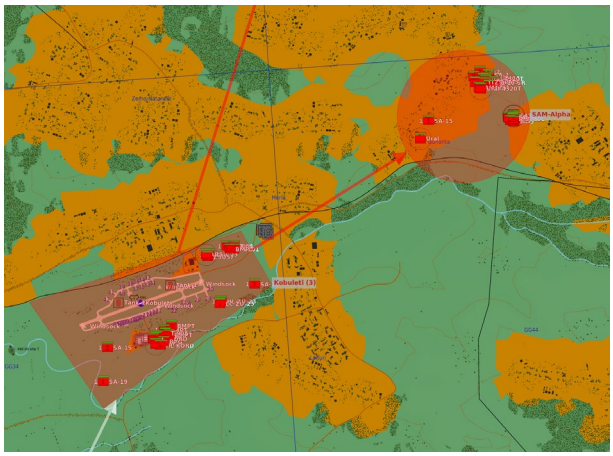
Statics only



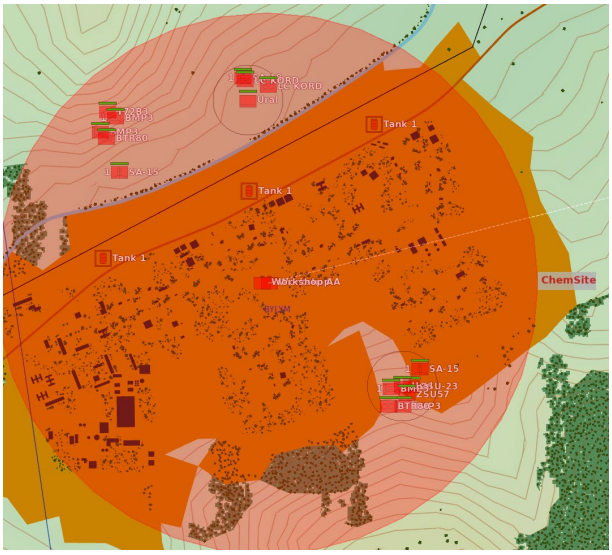
Purple - only static structures remain; no mobile defenders remain.



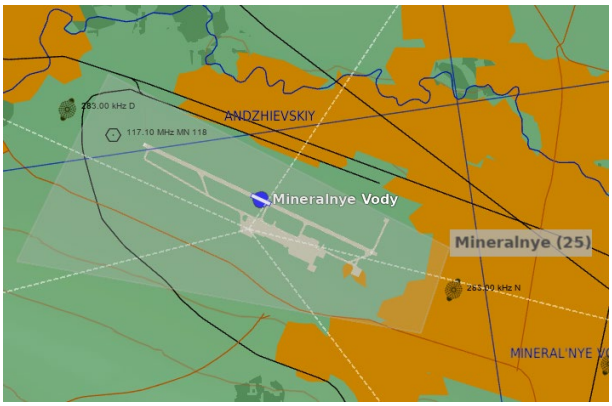
Friendly zone: name, waypoint, and upgrade status.



Hostile zones do not show an upgrade count.



SAM zone: defeat the air defenses before capture.



Neutral zones are intended to be captured.

5. Missions

Some missions in Foothold will always be there as a means to guide the player. View active missions at the top when the mission starts, or using the radio menu: Others > Missions.

5.1 Main Missions



Active missions are shown at the top of the screen.

Attack Mission

Starts when no current attack mission is active and at least one enemy zone is connected to the blue zone (white lines on F10 map). Ends when the target zone is neutral. All allies should cooperate to destroy all ground units and prevent hostile forces.

Dynamic operation areas — Foothold can open a third Attack! mission when players attack outside the recommended route. CAS, SEAD, and Runway Strike recommendations can then support the active Attack areas.

SEAD and Recon — SEAD may target a nearby defence zone when its SAMs threaten the current operation. Up to three Recon missions can cover the active Attack areas.

Supply Mission

Starts when a friendly zone needs supplies (recently captured and needs upgrades, or damaged by enemy attacks). Ends when the zone is fully upgraded and repaired. Each upgrade pays 200 credits.

Capture Mission

Starts when a zone is neutral and designed to be captured. Ends when friendly forces capture the zone or the red side recaptures it.

CAS Mission

Starts if no such mission is active. Selects a random number of targets for one player. First to reach that number wins. Dying or ejecting resets your kill count to 0. Land to redeem credits.

CAP Mission

Same logic as CAS mission, but targeting air units. Both helicopters and planes count.

Recon Mission

Fly above the target zone, enter and leave it. You get intel on the zone for 10 minutes and a reward. Intel shows map markers on all targets inside the zone.

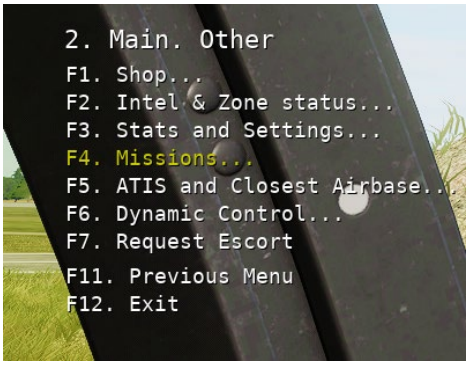
Bomb Runway

Prevents enemy planes from taking off. The mission chooses the best zone based on which has the most planes (CAP planes score higher). If the airbase has more than 1 runway, each must be bombed. Land to redeem. Any bomb weapon works.

5.2 Joint Missions

Joint missions allow up to four players to form one group. Every linked player shares the mission progress and receives the same full reward; the reward is not divided between players. Joint missions support CAP, CAS, Bomb Runway, Strike, and target-destruction missions such as intercepting bombers or enemy airstrikes.

To invite a player, open **Missions > Joint missions > Request joint with player**, then select the player from the current list. The invited player has 120 seconds to accept through **Pending joint requests**. Repeat the process to add players until the group contains four players. Use **Joint mission status** to view the group or **Leave Joint mission** to leave it.



Open Missions from Radio menu > Others.



Select Joint missions.



Select Request joint with player.



Choose the player you want to invite.



The invited player has 120 seconds to accept the request.

5.3 Side Missions

The scripted side missions below describe PvE events. Caucasus PvP disables the one-sided cargo interception, popup/SCUD and ground-escort event chains, and supplies separate coalition objectives instead; see Section 12.

Strike Mission

Find and kill a commander or strike a high value target. Coordinates found under Missions in the radio menu. Reward varies from 250 to 1000. Land to redeem.

Intercept Enemy Airstrike

The red side has deployed a strike group headed toward a friendly zone. Intercept the group. If more than 1 player participates, the reward is split. Land to redeem.

Intercept Enemy Bomber

Same logic as Intercept Enemy Airstrike. Land to redeem.

Intercept Enemy Cargo Plane

A cargo plane headed to an enemy airbase. Shoot it down to prevent landing. Land to redeem.

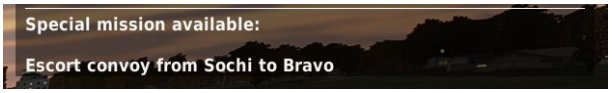
Helicopter Escort Mission

Escort a convoy from friendly zone to enemy zone. The route is not safe. Reward is 1000 (split if multiple players participate). The escort provides a FARP at ~70% distance. If the target zone is red when convoy arrives, they stop until you clear it. When the convoy reaches the end and the zone is neutral, they capture it for you.

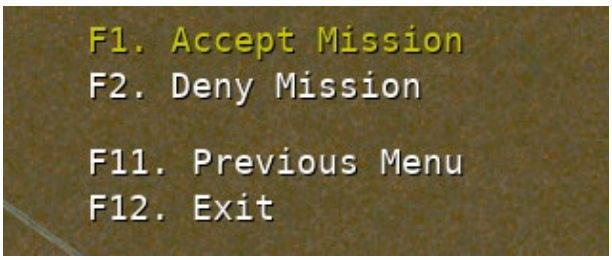
Escort Details

When you spawn at the escort zone in a helicopter, you'll be presented with a message. Open the radio menu > Others > Ground Escort. Once you accept, the convoy states it is ready.

A new radio menu appears where you can control the convoy: stop/move, request smoke, get bearing and distance. The convoy stops when it detects enemies and starts moving when safe (~1 NM distance). If the convoy gets killed, the mission fails and restarts after ~30 seconds.



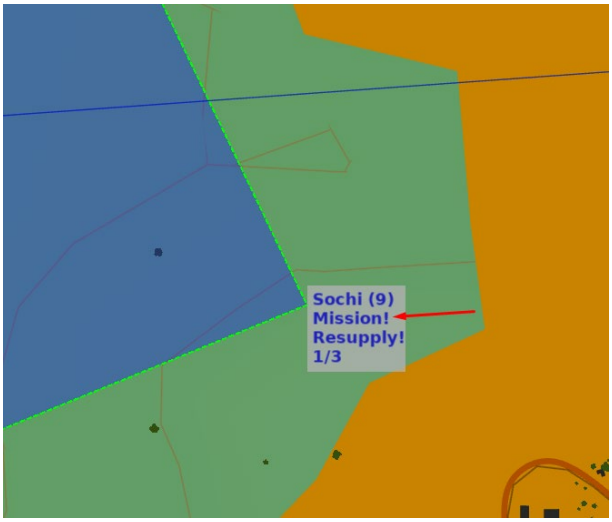
A Helicopter Escort mission becomes available.



Accept or deny the escort mission.



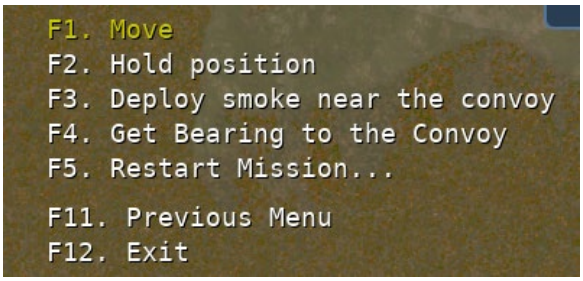
Open Ground Escort from the radio menu.



Ground Escort destination and resupply progress are shown on the F10 map.



The accepted convoy waits for your command.



Control the convoy: move, hold, smoke, bearing, or restart.

5.4 Tankers

Tankers can be unlocked for 1,000 credits by default. In PvE this remains a protected one-time purchase. In PvP a tanker can be destroyed; its controls and tracking are removed, and that coalition must purchase a new unlock. After a tanker is active, open Radio menu > Others > Tankers Control. Arco provides drogue refueling and Texaco provides boom refueling. Use the controls to change station, racetrack, altitude and speed; nearby players can temporarily prevent repositioning. Saved settings belong to the current tanker lifecycle. See Section 12 for PvP AWACS replacements.

5.5 Carrier Navigation

On maps that include carrier navigation areas, the carrier group moves automatically as Foothold routes become available. Open Radio menu > Others > Stats and Settings > Carrier Navigation. Carrier Info lists the active carrier groups, while Sail to <area> sends the group to another available carrier area. The mission announces the move, warns the coalition five minutes and one minute before a turn, and reports when a new destination becomes available. Some missions keep Carrier Navigation locked until Red Carrier is cleared.

When Config Manager > Mission options > Allow Tarawa To Move Freely is enabled, BLUE players can also place the following exact commands in F10 map-marker text. Marker routes must remain in friendly or neutral territory, use deep water, and provide a valid water route:

- tarawahelp — Show the available Tarawa marker commands.
- tarawahere or tarawahereandstop — Sail to the marker and stop.
- tarawahere1 — Save racetrack point 1.
- tarawahere2 — Save point 2 and start the racetrack; point 1 must be set first.
- tarawareturn — Leave the custom route and return Tarawa to its carrier area.

6. AI Behaviour

6.1 Dynamic AI

Both CAP and supply groups on the red side have dynamic spawn rates heavily dependent on the number of players. Exceptions: A-10, C-130, and helicopter pilots are not counted. If only those are present, the CAP stays at the lowest rate and the supply timer is doubled.

If at least 1 player is flying an F/A-18C, F-16C, or any other jet, enemy CAP will increase. This increases further with 4+ players.

The RED Director coordinates attacks on BLUE zones, including CAS, SEAD, strike packages, and ground attacks. Air missions follow the selected difficulty and counted-player limits. Bombing enemy runways can stop fixed-wing departures; RED attack helicopters are not stopped by runway damage.

When capturing some zones, the red side might counter-attack with Scuds or ground offensives. Red may also send artillery to fire at blue zones.

Normandy bombers — RED bomber operations are coordinated by the RED Director. BLUE bombers support a current Attack mission, preferring a target under player pressure; without player pressure they choose from the current Attack missions. Their existing independent launch timing remains in use. If no Attack mission is available, the normal eligible-target selection is used.

6.2 Hunt Mechanic

If you're too good at hunting enemy ground units, they might hunt you down. Anything except the A-10 and helicopters can be hunted. The enemy will dispatch 2 jets. If this happens, you'll hear 'Watch your six'. There is no way out except to kill them or go home.

6.3 Ground AI Units

Most missions have red ground units patrolling instead of parked. They move around the zone at different formations and speeds, making it more challenging but easier to find with A/G radar.

BLUE Defence Response

When BLUE defences are breached, nearby BLUE ground forces can counterattack enemy ground forces, artillery, and MLRS. Coalition messages report the breach and announce when a counterattack is dispatched. BLUE SAM batteries remain in position while detecting and reporting attackers.

6.4 AIEN

The mission uses AIEN by Chromium. Ground units react to hits and attacks: drop smoke, flee, panic, hide behind buildings, seek support, and more. Foothold modifies these reactions to respect zone rules. AIEN also runs on Kola, although its independent initiative advance is disabled there.

6.5 Quiet Zones and Performance

More zones suspend when there is no activity in that area, improving performance on heavy maps. Their ground defenders are temporarily removed while zone ownership and saved upgrades are retained. Player proximity and operations that need the zone's defenders can wake them again. Quiet friendly zones remain friendly and can still be used to spawn.

6.6 MANTIS

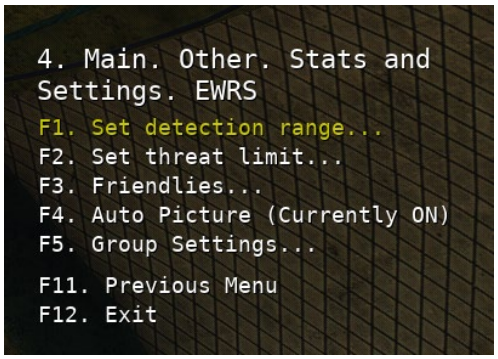
Foothold uses MANTIS by MOOSE. All SAM sites are connected to a network via AWACS and EWR (Early Warning Radar) strategically placed across the map. SAMs are turned off by default until you are within range (detected by EWR).

- If you take out all EWR, the SAM network will shut down and a backup system activates (random SAMs turn on briefly).
- MANTIS has Point of Defense, SHORAD, and SAM in short/medium/long range.
- Mobile groups will evade — if a HARM is detected, they start moving.
- SHORAD has Shoot N' Scoot capability (shoot then move).

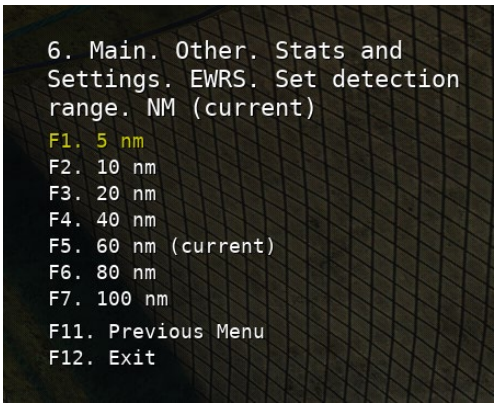
6.7 EWRS (Early Warning Radar System)

Where EWRS is enabled, open Radio menu > Others > Stats and Settings > EWRS. The choices are stored per player group, so one flight can use a different picture range or display than another.

- Detection range — Choose KM or NM, then the maximum distance to report: 10–150 km or 5–100 NM. Choosing the unit also changes the group's report measurements.
- Threat limit — Sets how many hostile contacts appear in each picture: 1–5 or All. It limits the report length; it does not change radar detection or enemy difficulty.
- Friendlies — Toggle friendly aircraft, choose a 1–5 friendly-contact limit, and independently show or hide tankers.
- Auto Picture — Turns recurring picture messages on or off. Group Settings selects ownship or Bullseye as the reference, metric or imperial units, and report Style 1 or Style 2.



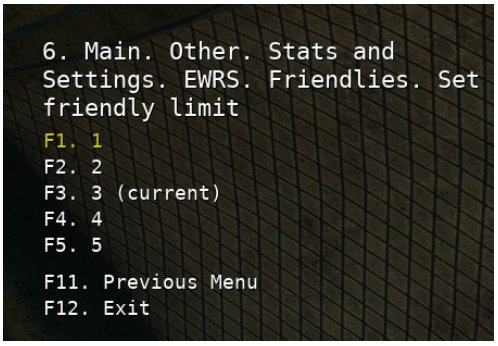
EWRS main settings.



Choose an NM detection range.



Toggle friendly aircraft and tankers.



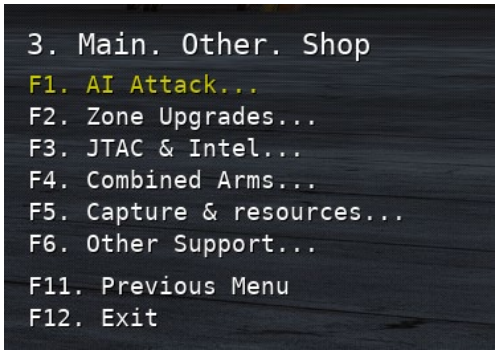
Limit friendly contacts in reports.

7. Shop

The credit system is shared within the coalition. Every contribution (kills, missions, rescues) adds to the bank. There are 2 ways to buy things: radio menu or map markers.

7.1 Radio Menu Shop

Access via: Radio menu > Others > Shop. Most items require you to select a target zone. The cost will be deducted from the coalition bank.



Shop categories include AI Attack, Zone Upgrades, JTAC, Combined Arms, and support.

Shop item overview

Available items depend on the mission, selected era, Config Manager settings, and the buyer's rank. The menu only shows purchases currently available to that group.

- **AI Attack** — launches coalition-controlled CAP, CAS, bomber, SEAD, TALD decoy, ground-attack, strategic-bomber, or static-structure missions. Availability varies by mission and era; airborne groups are managed through Dynamic Control.
- **Zone Upgrades** — adds permanent infantry, armor, individual SAM/AAA systems, artillery, or EWR upgrades where the map and era allow them. An extra-slot purchase unlocks one more purchased upgrade per eligible zone.
- **JTAC & Intel** — deploys an MQ-9 or era-specific JTAC, provides AM/FM 9-line support, marks targets with smoke, flares, or illumination, and can reveal enemy-zone groups with temporary satellite intel.
- **Combined Arms** — spawns controllable armor, artillery, recon, or air-defence units at a friendly zone. These immediate support groups are not part of the permanent zone-upgrade list.
- **Capture & resources** — requests neutral or advance capture, resupplies or fully upgrades a friendly zone, builds or repairs a Logistics Center, adds ready supplies, or replenishes warehouse stock. Normandy also offers Repair train route.
- **Other Support** — unlocks drogue or boom tankers and provides the Deploy FARP marker workflow described below.

Budget overview shows the coalition balance, any stock-limited purchases, and unclaimed player contributions.

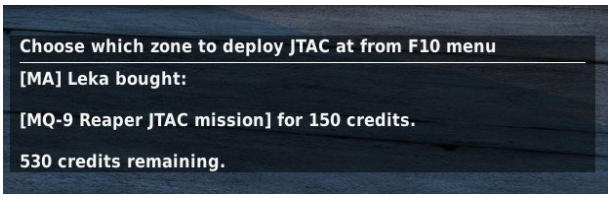
7.2 JTAC (MQ-9 Reaper)

A drone that auto-lases the highest priority threat in the zone. Laser is set to 1688. Once deployed, it builds a target list and lases the highest threat. When the lased target is killed, it switches to the next target. Once the zone is neutral, JTAC despawns.

JTAC Menu

- F1. Target Report — Display current target with coordinates, movement status and direction.
- F2. Next Target — Give a random target from the JTAC's target list.
- F3. Smoke on Target — Orange smoke deployed on the current lased target.
- F4. Set Priority — Choose between Structure, SAM, Armor, Support, and Infantry.
- F5. Set Laser Code — Change the JTAC's laser code.
- F6. Select Target — Manually select a target from the JTAC's full target list.

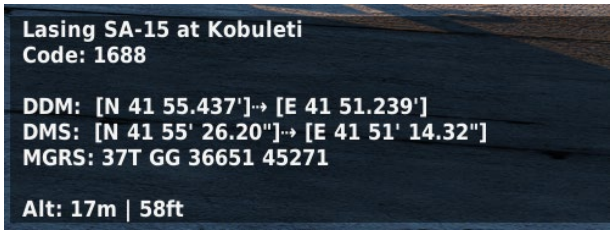
JTAC can detect spawned units inside the deployment zone and will announce them.



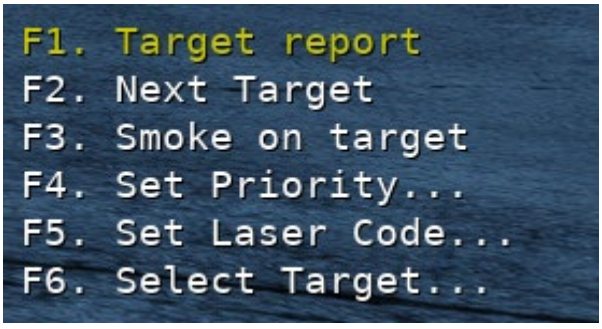
Purchase the MQ-9 Reaper JTAC and choose its deployment zone.



JTAC deploys and searches for targets.



Target Report shows the lased target, code, coordinates, and altitude.



JTAC menu: report, next target, smoke, priority, laser code, and target selection.

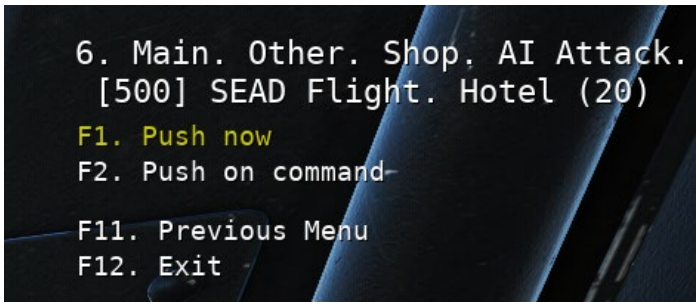
7.3 AI Attack Groups

Available AI attack types: CAP, CAS, Bomb Run, SEAD, Decoy, and Building Strike. All create a Dynamic Control radio menu where you can destroy them or control them. Note: Dynamic Building Strike is NOT available on all maps.

Buy CAP through Radio menu > Others > Shop > AI Attack > CAP Flight. Select the zone where the CAP will operate. Choose Orbit to remain over the zone, or choose a Hot heading for a racetrack; a Hot racetrack also requires a 10-50 NM leg length.

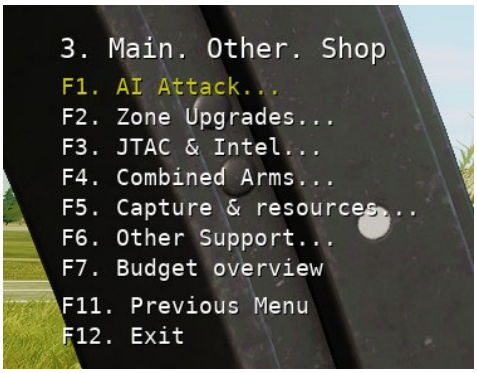
SEAD and Decoy launch options

After selecting the target, choose Push now for the automatic attack or Push on command to hold the flight for your instruction. Ground-start flights must take off and reach their required altitude first. Foothold announces when they are ready; for command mode, use the available Push SEAD or Push Decoy option under Dynamic Control. A TALD Decoy mission distracts hostile radars rather than destroying the zone itself.

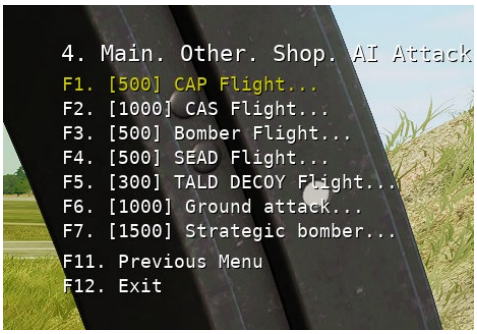


Purchase options for SEAD: automatic push or a later player command. This is the launch-mode menu.

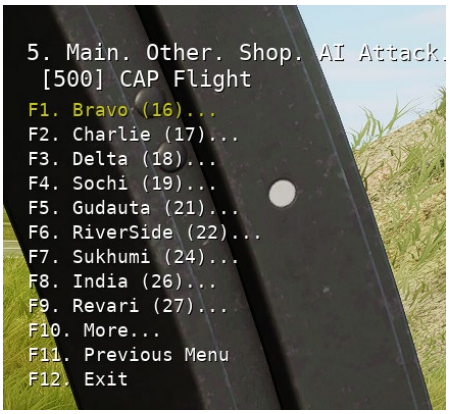
- F1. Spawn friendly group — Force an instant friendly group spawn at a neutral zone (instead of waiting).
- F9. Smoke — Deploy red smoke on 3 different targets in the zone.



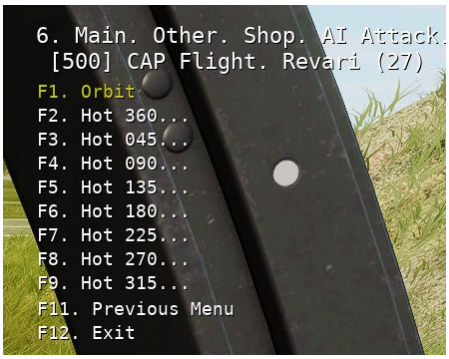
Open Shop and select AI Attack.



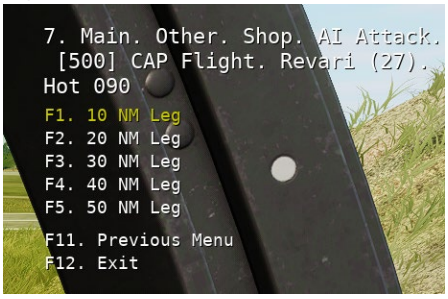
Choose CAP Flight from AI Attack.



Select the zone where the CAP will operate.



Choose Orbit or a Hot racetrack heading.



For a Hot racetrack, choose the leg length.

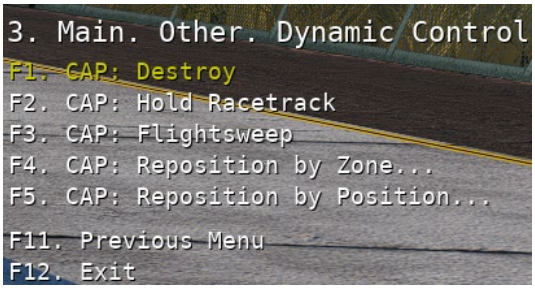
7.4 CAP Control

SAM awareness — CAP racetracks account for known operational enemy SAM coverage when choosing their patrol route. This reduces exposure but does not guarantee safety from every threat; use the control menu to adjust the patrol as the situation changes.

Once the CAP is airborne, you will have a control menu:

- F1. Destroy — Remove the CAP.
- F2. Hold (default: true) — CAP maintains racetrack and only engages if engaged.
- F3. Engage — CAP engages everything at maximum range.
- F4. Move to Zone — Relocate CAP to another zone with a new racetrack.
- F5. Move by Position — Move CAP by distance/direction from your position.

If the CAP runs out of A/A missiles, they will RTB.



Dynamic Control: destroy, hold, engage, or reposition the CAP.

7.5 Other Shop Categories

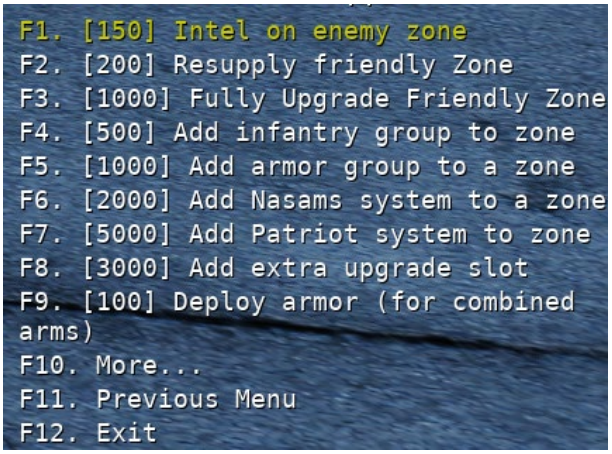
- F1. Intel — Makes sense of what's inside a zone. Enables Zone Status to show targets. Valid for 1 hour. Also places map markers on each group.
- F2. Resupply — Repairs or upgrades one group in a friendly zone. Buy multiple for multiple groups.
- F3. Full Upgrade — Fully upgrades a zone even if it's at 1/5.
- Permanent Zone Upgrades — Each purchase adds its own defensive group. HAWK and NASAMS are separate purchases, as are Avenger, Roland, Gepard, Vulcan, and C-RAM where available. HAWK and NASAMS no longer include C-RAM as part of their group; purchase it separately. The selected era and map determine which systems are offered.
- Extra Upgrade Slot — Non-WW2 maps allow two purchased zone upgrades without an unlock; the coalition unlock enables a third. Normandy allows one purchased upgrade, then a second after unlocking. These purchased slots are additional to the zone's normal upgrade groups.
- F9 + next page items. Combined Arms — Spawn units immediately at a zone. Not saved between sessions. Can be used to defend or move to target zone.
- F4-F5. DCS JTAC — Standard DCS JTAC (does not auto-lase). Requires manual radio procedure on provided frequency.

Normandy train repairs

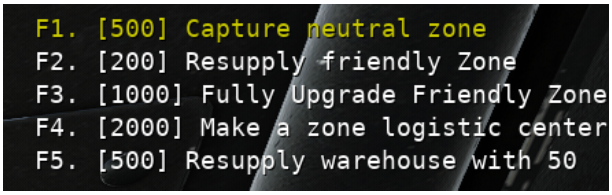
Choose Shop > Capture & resources > Repair train route, then select the destroyed route by its origin → destination names. The origin must be BLUE; the destination does not have to be BLUE. Repair restores the train route for its normal supply service. The route list refreshes as ownership and train availability change. Default price: 2,000 credits, Rank 1.



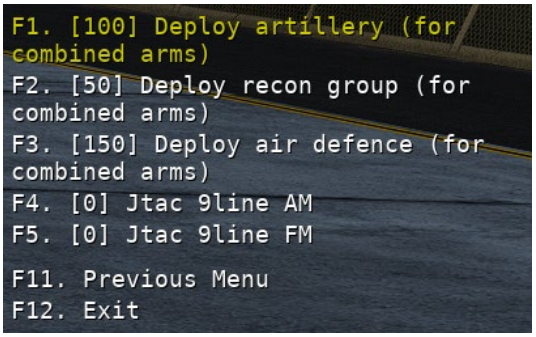
Normandy train-repair choices show each route's origin and destination.



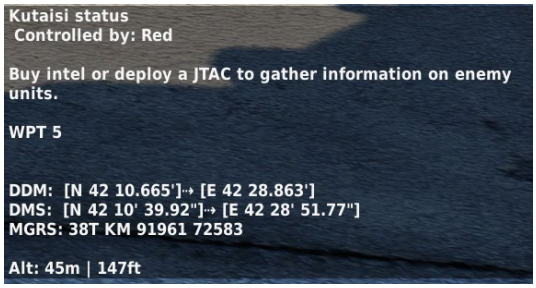
Shop menu: Intel, resupply, upgrades, and Combined Arms.



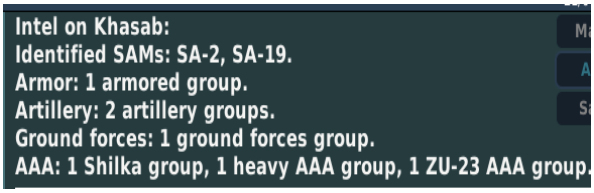
Zone purchases include capture, resupply, upgrades, and logistics centers.



Other Support includes Combined Arms units and DCS JTAC.



Without Intel, Zone Status hides enemy units.



Purchased Intel reveals enemy groups.



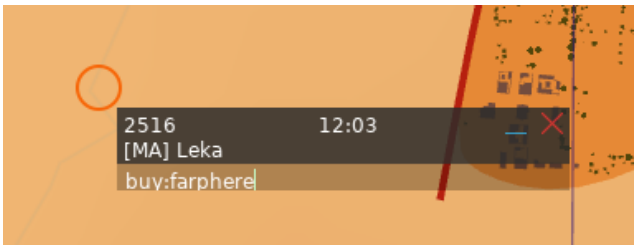
Group amount will be displayed on the zone label.

Deploy FARP

Use the coalition shop's paid Deploy FARP action and select the intended site. The purchase sends a supply helicopter from an eligible friendly airbase; construction completes after it lands at the site. Terrain, source, distance and delivery conditions still apply. This is separate from the ordinary marker-FARP Admin action in Section 13.

The marker must be outside an existing Foothold zone, at least 10 NM from an enemy zone, and close to a flat landing area. A friendly launch airbase must be within 100 NM. If a requirement is not met, Foothold reports the reason.

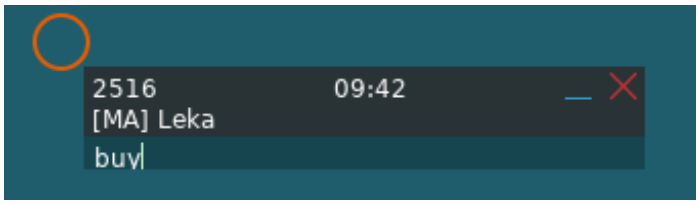
The completed paid FARP becomes a CTLD loading point for the purchasing coalition where that national service is supported. It includes warehouse services and starts with [SUP] 1. Players must deliver replacement or surplus stock. Rank and availability settings still apply; this paid deployment is separate from the custom ordinary-FARP Admin command in Section 13.



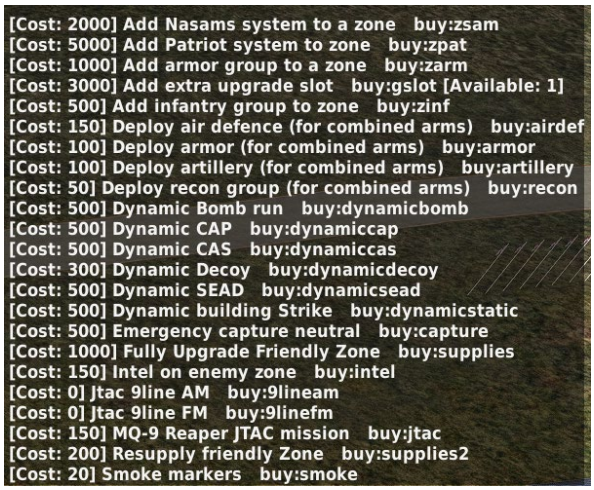
Once that is written, with your mouse click elsewhere. Don't use enter

7.6 Map Marker Purchases

You can use map markers to buy shop items. Type buy to print all item IDs. Then place a map marker inside the target zone and type buy:<itemID> (e.g., buy:smoke). Click anywhere else to confirm.



Type buy in a map marker to request the item list.



Foothold prints the available item IDs and buy commands.



Place the marker in the target zone and type buy:<itemID>.

8. CTLD

Using CTLD you can build SAMs, build FARPs, take artillery and place it near enemy zones (they fire automatically with JTAC), and capture zones using troops.

8.1 CTLD-Capable Units

CH-47F, UH-1H, C-130J-30, MI-8, Bronco, UH-60L, Mi-24P, OH-58D, KA-50, AH-64D. Not all of these can carry every item. The list marks units that have the CTLD menu.

8.2 Troops

Use Manage Troops to load, drop and extract troop groups. Eligible troops retain their own pickup origin, including through extraction and later unloading. A valid delivery from another zone may capture an eligible neutral zone or supply a friendly zone that needs it. Inside-zone capture, supply and returned-home unloading do not count as troop deployments or grant deployment achievements. Eligible deployments outside zones can count. Specialist teams retain their separate roles.

> **Important**
> Use 'Drop All' to capture/upgrade zones. When a zone is already blue, dropping troops inside will destroy them (returned to base).

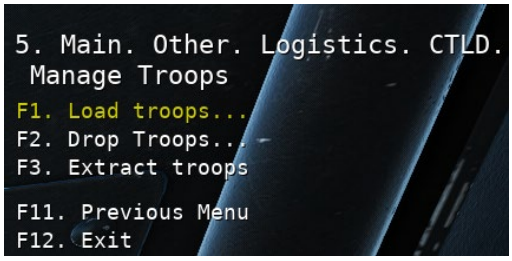
Deployed troops can be extracted again using Manage Troops > Extract troops. Each onboard group keeps its own origin; loading other troops or crates does not give extracted troops a different group's pickup record. Friendly returns preserve the normal purchase-cost refund. Missing-origin troops cannot capture, supply or upgrade a zone and do not earn an inside-zone deployment count, but their eligible return/refund is preserved.

Kills by your deployed CTLD troops and built CTLD units can earn contribution against enemy units while you remain in an eligible player aircraft. The standard Blue path remains; PvP also credits qualifying Red builders and deployments for enemy kills. Config Manager > Shop / Rewards controls the contribution amounts. In PvP, Red C-130 airdropped builds also contribute to their build and airdrop statistics; see Section 8.5.

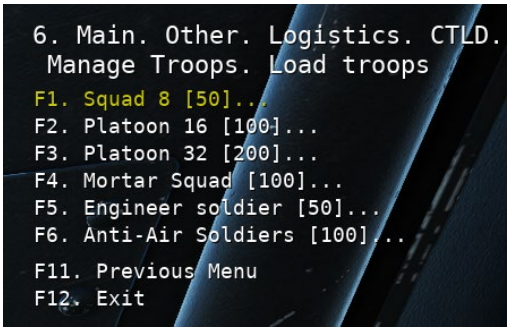
Special Teams

Zone Spy — deploy within 5,000 m of a hostile Foothold zone. The Spy infiltrates the zone, activates Intel for 60 minutes, then returns to the deployment point and waits for extraction.

Demolition Team — enters a hostile Foothold zone, destroys enemy structures, then returns to the deployment point for extraction. Multiple teams in the same zone divide the available structure targets. Demolition Teams cannot capture, supply, or upgrade zones; players receive credits for the structures they destroy.



Manage Troops: load, drop, or extract deployed troops.

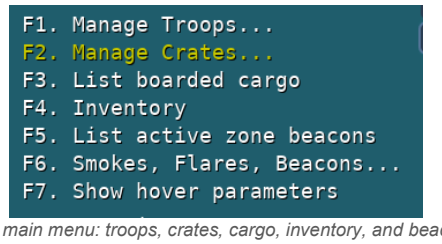


Choose the troop group and size to load.

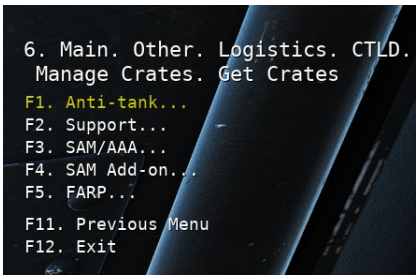
8.3 Crates

Use Manage Crates to obtain, load, unload, build, repair, pack, or return CTLD cargo. The main categories include:

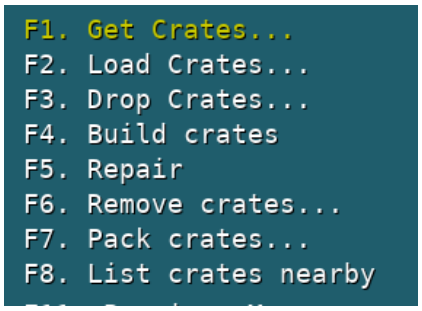
- Anti-tank and support units
- SAM/AAA systems and SAM Add-ons
- L118 Artillery, which fires on enemy targets provided by JTAC
- Normal FARP and FARP with ZELL builds



CTLD main menu: troops, crates, cargo, inventory, and beacons.



Crate categories include anti-tank, support, SAM/AAA, SAM Add-on, and FARP.



Manage Crates: get, load, drop, build, repair, or remove crates.

Artillery

L118 Artillery is deployed from CTLD crates near an enemy zone. Once built, it automatically fires at targets supplied by a friendly JTAC. The L118 must be within 7 NM of the target zone; otherwise, it will not fire. HIMARS can engage targets between 9 and 29 NM. Targets closer than 9 NM or farther than 29 NM are outside its firing range.



L118 Artillery fires at JTAC targets.

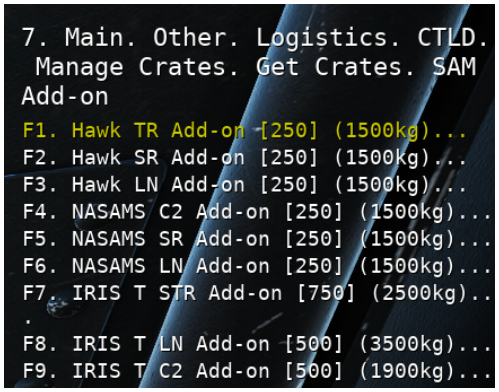


L118 Artillery deployed near an enemy zone.

SAM Add-ons

Use Get Crates > SAM Add-on to bring individual tracking-radar, search-radar, launcher, or command components to an existing HAWK, NASAMS, or IRIS-T system. Build the component within 400 m of a matching live system and it merges into that site.

Because the merge preserves the units that are still alive, an add-on can replace a destroyed component, such as a tracking radar, or expand a working system with additional supported units.

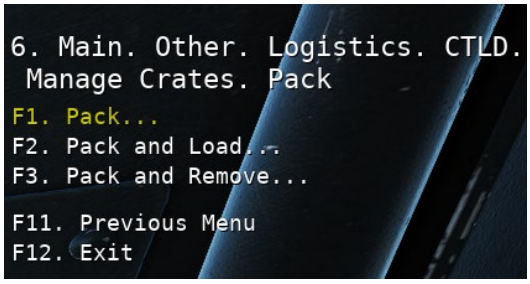


SAM Add-on crates provide individual HAWK, NASAMS, and IRIS-T components.

Packing and returning crates

Built CTLD vehicles and systems can be converted back into cargo with Manage Crates > Pack. Pack leaves the crates on the ground, Pack and Load places them aboard when capacity allows, and Pack and Remove removes them immediately. Built FARPs cannot be packed.

To reclaim the purchase cost, return packed cargo to a friendly zone and select Remove crates nearby. When CTLD costs are enabled, the purchase cost is refunded; warehouse-item cargo is also returned to that zone's local stock.



Pack a built group, load it, or remove it for a return at a friendly loading zone.

8.4 Building and Operating a FARP

Normal FARP and FARP with ZELL are three-crate builds. Drop the required crates outside an existing Foothold zone, then use Manage Crates > Build crates. The ZELL option is available only on missions that include its required template.

Both variants create a BLUE CTLD loading zone, provide warehouse services, and start with [SUP] 1. That supply is stored stock: player pickups reduce it and delivered zone supplies increase it. CTLD FARPs do not self-produce supplies.

With WarehouseLogistics enabled, each new FARP receives 30 of most weapon items and 90 air-to-ground rockets. The ZELL variant also creates a separate ZELL launch point stocked with F-100D aircraft and fuel.

Built-FARP positions and stored supplies persist with the mission. Config Manager > CTLD sets the saved-FARP limit; it also controls crate weights, aircraft capacity, costs, ranks, and saved CTLD-unit limits.

C-130 credit redemption — If you are landed in a C-130 when your newly built FARP completes, Foothold automatically redeems your pending credits through the normal landing-reward check. Restored FARPs do not trigger this payment.



Choose a normal three-crate FARP or the three-crate FARP with ZELL.



A completed FARP with ZELL provides a CTLD loading zone, warehouse, and ZELL launch point.

8.5 Red CTLD and C-130 airdrops

Red CTLD becomes available when Caucasus PvP is enabled or Allow Red CTLD is enabled for PvE. This enables the Red integration; it does not make every newer PvP-only item available in PvE. Check the CTLD Items grid for the chosen Era, availability, price, required rank and Max saved.

In PvP, Red C-130J-30 flights can load cargo, carry troops, airdrop equipment and use automatic building after the cargo reaches the ground. Use the same loading and airdrop procedure described in Sections 3.3 and 3.4, with the Red CTLD menu and Red cargo. A successful build retains Red ownership and credits the delivering player. Qualifying SAM builds earn contribution and CTLD/build/airdrop statistics; the default SAM build contribution is 150 credits.

Blue Pantsir S1 and Red Tor M2 are Modern PvP-only CTLD choices. Allow Red CTLD in PvE does not unlock Tor M2, and changing the Era does not make either system available in Coldwar or Vietnam. Each uses two 3,000 kg crates. Red SA-8 uses two 2,000 kg crates; Red SA-3 uses four 4,000 kg crates.

In PvP, Pantsir S1, Tor M2 and SA-8 cannot be built within 8 NM of another friendly CTLD-built system of the same type. This covers manual, automatic and batch building. A blocked set stays as cargo; it is not silently replaced by another SAM. Ordinary zone defenses and different SAM types do not consume this same-type spacing allowance.

In PvP, a Red FARP or FARP with ZELL kit supplies the Red CTLD path when that cargo is available. The native FARP airbase can be captured or blocked by an enemy ground presence, preventing the former owner from using stale services. This does not automatically transfer the complete CTLD asset record to the new coalition.

9. CSAR (Combat Search and Rescue)

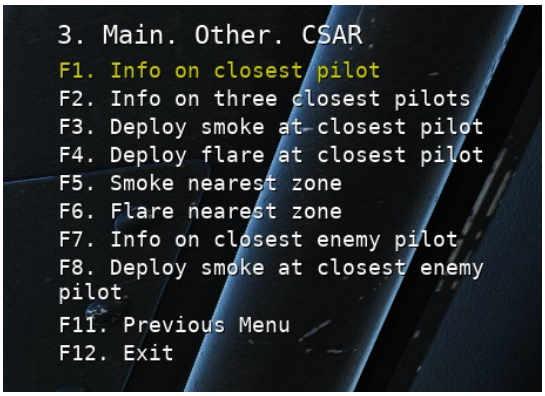
9.1 Rescue Overview

When a player ejects and the pilot survives, helicopter crews receive a rescue message. Open Radio menu > Others > CSAR to locate and mark the survivor.

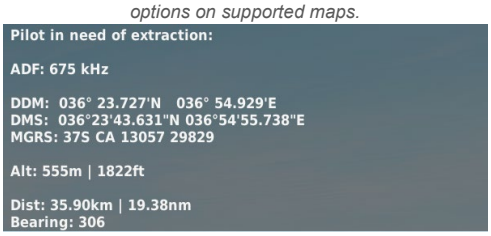
The mission stores the pilot's lost 75% of unredeemed credits so it can be recovered through CSAR.

9.2 CSAR Menu

- Info on closest pilot / three closest pilots — Reports ADF frequency, DDM, DMS and MGRS coordinates, altitude, distance, and bearing.
- Deploy smoke / flare at closest pilot — Marks the nearest survivor for visual identification.
- Smoke / flare nearest zone — Marks the nearest Foothold zone when you need a reference or delivery point.



CSAR menu: friendly rescue controls and enemy-pilot report/smoke options on supported maps.



The survivor report includes ADF, coordinates, altitude, distance, and bearing.

9.3 Recovering a Pilot

Complete a player rescue by delivering the survivor to any friendly Foothold zone or CTLD FARP.

Hover pickup — Hold within 20 m horizontally, below 60 m AGL, and at no more than 5 m/s for 10 seconds. Inside 70 m, guidance calls forward/back, left/right, and height corrections.

Landing pickup — Land within 650 m. The survivor runs to the helicopter and boards when within 20 m.

Territory and automatic return — A survivor in a neutral or hostile zone can still be rescued while alive. If that area becomes BLUE and the survivor is within 3 NM of a friendly Foothold zone or FARP, the pilot runs home automatically.

Credits — A player rescuer receives the normal rescue reward plus the rescued pilot's stored lost credits. If the survivor reaches a friendly zone without pickup, the stored credits are restored for the original pilot's recovery record.

Configuration — Config Manager > CSAR can change the pickup distances, hover height, guidance range, and required hover time.

> **Danger near the survivor**
> At default settings there is a 25% chance hostile infantry spawn around a downed pilot. Approach carefully and clear the area before committing to the pickup.

9.4 Capturing Enemy Pilots

On maps that provide enemy downed pilots, BLUE CSAR crews can capture surviving RED pilots. The general announcement gives the reported location. Use CSAR > Info on closest enemy pilot for a report measured from your aircraft, including distance and bearing. Deploy smoke at closest enemy pilot marks a nearby offset from the pilot; search the indicated area.



Player-requested closest enemy pilot report, including distance and bearing from the requesting aircraft.

Capture — Use a CSAR-capable aircraft with a free seat. Hover using the normal CSAR distance, height, speed, and countdown rules, or land within 50 m of the pilot. Enemy pilots do not run toward your aircraft from the friendly 650 m landing-pickup radius. Hostile troops may appear during the approach, so secure the area first.

Delivery — Land inside a friendly Foothold zone to hand over captured enemy pilots; in PvP this means the delivering coalition's zone. A CTLD-only FARP is not an enemy-pilot handover point. The normal capture contribution is 200 credits per pilot by default. In PvP, an enemy player pilot additionally carries the credits lost when that survivor was created; delivery credits that amount through the normal reward process.

Debriefing — AI enemy pilots can provide Intel after handover: each has a 50% chance for 30 minutes of zone Intel and a separate 20% chance to reveal opposing Director plans, at most one result of each kind per handover. In PvP this applies for both coalitions. Captured player pilots use their capture/carried-credit reward instead of this AI interrogation roll; reports identify high-value pilots without revealing their exact carried amount.

Availability — These enemy-pilot controls appear only where the mission includes the required enemy-pilot template. Friendly CSAR remains available separately; Normandy currently does not provide enemy-pilot capture.

10. Private Escort

10.1 Escort Availability

Available for A-10, Hercules (C-130J-30), and F-15E Strike Eagle. You'll see a message pop up when you take off. Once you accept, 2 F/A-18s will fly 10,000 feet above you.



Private Escort becomes available after takeoff.

10.2 Escort Controls

A radio menu is created to control them:

- By default, the escort only engages if engaged.
- Protection distance is set to 40 NM.
- Switching to Flightsweep makes the escort leave you and hunt targets.



Escort control: flightsweep, engagement mode, patrol, racetrack, orbit, rejoin, or RTB.

11. Stats and Budget

11.1 Player Statistics

Access via: Radio menu > Others > Stats and Budget. View your stats (kills, deaths, etc.); these are saved until the mission is completed.



Stats and Budget menu: player statistics or Budget Overview.



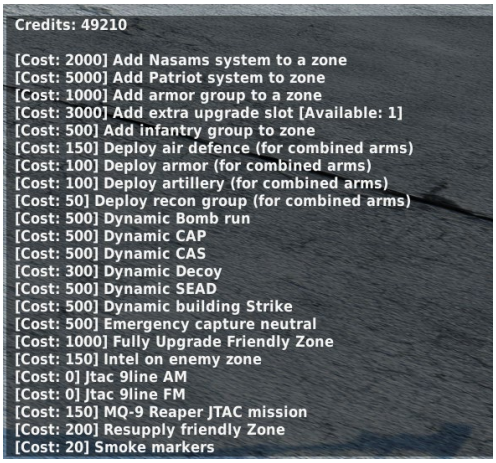
Stats menu: My Stats, All Stats, or Top 5 Players.

Same Aircraft Bonus

Keep your aircraft after a successful credit redemption and fly another sortie to receive the Same Aircraft Bonus. The first qualifying redemption must follow at least five minutes airborne. The next takeoff activates the bonus, adding 10% by default to later redeemed contribution. Losing, ejecting from, or spawning a replacement aircraft resets it. The percentage does not increase with each sortie; administrators can change or disable it in Shop / Rewards.

11.2 Budget Overview

The Budget Overview shows how much each item costs and how much the coalition has earned.



Budget Overview lists coalition credits and current prices.

12. Caucasus PvP

This section explains how to configure a PvP round and how the two coalitions use their own objectives, logistics and support. The earlier sections still describe shared controls and PvE; the rules below identify the PvP differences.

12.1 Start a Caucasus PvP campaign

Caucasus PvP lets Blue and Red fight for the campaign using their own services, objectives and support. The current PvP setup supports Modern, Coldwar and Vietnam. Other maps do not become PvP missions by enabling the checkbox: the current configuration keeps PvP disabled outside Caucasus.

1. Open the configuration used by your Caucasus mission.
2. Select the **Era**, then enable **Caucasus PvP**.
3. Choose **Starting Territory Per Coalition**. The percentage applies to each side, with the remainder neutral.
4. Choose the starting direction with StartNormal. With true, Blue starts from Anapa and Red from Vaziani; with false, Red starts from Anapa and Blue from Vaziani.
5. Set the PvP AI, escort and aircraft-list options described below. Check shop availability, prices and ranks for the intended game.
6. Save, then start a new or reset PvP campaign.

Selection	Red territory	Blue territory	Neutral territory
20	20%	20%	60%
30	30%	30%	40%
40	40%	40%	20%
50	50%	50%	0%

The mission rounds these shares to whole eligible regular/SAM zones. Industrial sites follow their connected region and are outside this main territorial allocation.

Starting territory and direction apply to a fresh campaign. Loading a saved round retains its ownership and saved direction. PvP uses separate campaign save names for the selected Era; enabling PvP does not convert a running PvE campaign into a new PvP round.

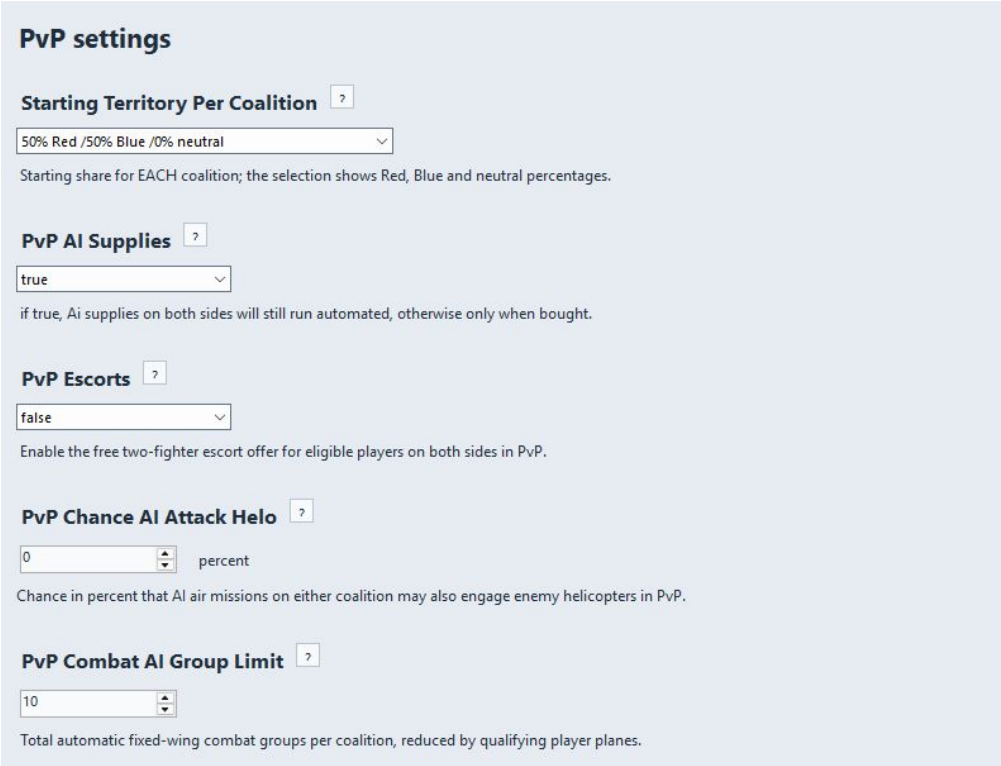
The two starting Logistics Centers begin a fresh PvP round with their ready [SUP] stock filled to the configured warehouse supply target. This applies to those starting zones, not every airbase. Capturing and building other zones remains part of the campaign.

Blue carrier availability follows the campaign direction and Era. In the Anapa direction it follows Blue's Anapa start. In the Vaziani direction, Blue must own Batumi before the initial carrier deployment there becomes eligible. Carriers are unavailable in Vietnam. Existing saved carrier navigation takes precedence. PvP does not add a Red carrier.

The round continues while both sides hold at least one of the main victory zones. A side wins when its opponent owns none of those zones and it still owns at least one. Remaining neutral zones do not prevent victory. The mission announces the result; the configured reset and server mission-loading rules determine what loads next.

12.2 Choose the amount of AI support

PvP Combat AI Group Limit is a shared automatic fixed-wing combat allowance for each coalition. It is not a separate allowance for every role. Qualifying player planes on that coalition reduce the available allowance. For example, a limit of 10 with three qualifying player planes leaves a capacity of seven automatic combat groups. This setting controls admission; it is not a command to erase every other mission activity.



Config Manager PvP settings: starting territory, automatic supplies, escorts and combat AI.

Player helicopters do not consume this fixed-wing allowance. Aircraft-count ignore lists can exclude selected plane types. Zero prevents new qualifying automatic combat dispatches; paid support, supply settings, saving and other enabled services remain separate.

PvP AI Supplies controls automatic supply missions for both coalitions. Disable it to require purchased supply missions instead. It is separate from the combat AI limit. Existing player services, paid support, recovery and campaign saving continue when automatic combat and automatic supply are disabled.

PvP Escorts enables the free two-fighter escort offer for eligible players on both sides. The aircraft-to-escort settings still control which player types qualify. Escorts are disabled by default.

PvP Chance AI Attack Helo sets the percentage chance that the affected AI air missions may also attack enemy helicopters. Zero disables that targeting option and 100 always allows it. InvisibleA10 takes precedence.

Different aircraft per coalition (PvP) selects separate Blue and Red warehouse aircraft lists. Without it, Coldwar and Vietnam use a shared PvP list for both sides, separate from the PvE lists. Modern without separate lists has no aircraft-list restriction from this option. Warehouse lists control aircraft inventory; they do not add client slots or change the aircraft and payloads authored in the mission.

Keep aircraft marked **Used by AI** available for the enabled features. Required aircraft can include transport helicopters, support aircraft and purchased missions as well as combat aircraft. If you update an older external configuration, review the new PvP lists instead of assuming old custom choices were copied into them.

12.3 Fight, supply and replace losses

Both coalitions receive their own Supply, Attack, Capture, SEAD/DEAD, Recon, CAP, CAS and Runway objectives. Use your coalition's menus and reports. Purchases and rewards belong to the coalition making the transaction.

Joint-mission player lists show your own coalition only. Recon and purchased Intel belong to the receiving coalition; revealed enemy-zone labels can identify warehouse and EWR assets. Do not assume that an enemy receives your private mission coordinates or recon information.

The national shops offer corresponding CAP, CAS, SEAD, Bomber and Strategic support where the selected Era permits them. The aircraft and some equipment differ by coalition. **Decoy remains Blue-only.** Availability, price, minimum rank and current stock still apply. Shared player warehouse build/repair services are available to both sides.

Zone Upgrades use national equipment. Modern PvP gives Blue a Pantsir option and Red a Tor M2 option; Red cannot purchase Pantsir. These two additions are Modern-only. Other national upgrades retain their own Era restrictions, availability, prices and ranks.

Industrial strike objectives group the eligible buildings in one zone into one objective. The listed objective reward is 300 per included building, capped at 1,000. Eligible remaining industrial buildings must have friendly territory within 100 NM. Fixed EWR objectives use a separate 50 NM friendly-territory range in PvP. These are objective-offer ranges, not radar detection ranges or weapon limits.

Fixed EWR sites are campaign assets: destroying them reduces the opposing network's coverage. They are not automatically replenished as ordinary fixed-network losses. Purchased EWR zone upgrades are separate assets. In PvP, those purchased radars remain active even while their zone's ordinary defenses are suspended, and radar casualties remain losses.

Each coalition has two AWACS slots. They are invisible to AI but can be destroyed. After a loss, use **Other Support → Replace one lost AWACS** to replace one lost slot; a single purchase does not replace both. The offer appears only while that coalition has a loss.

Dynamic tankers can also be destroyed in PvP. A loss removes that tanker's active controls and requires another paid unlock. This differs from the protected one-time-unlock behavior in PvE.

Regular [SUP] stock and warehouse weapons/resources are different supplies. An eligible suspended supply source can continue producing regular stock and can support automatic supply flights when that option is enabled. A paid delivery already accepted for an active ordinary target can still finish if that target later becomes suspended; its defenses remain asleep. This does not guarantee that a new purchase can select an already fully suspended target.

12.4 Troops and CSAR in PvP

Red and Blue use their own CTLD services. Red CTLD is enabled by PvP even when the separate Red-in-PvE option is off. Cargo availability, price, rank and mission conditions still apply. Modern PvP gives Blue Pantsir and Red Tor M2; Red cannot acquire Pantsir. In PvP, CTLD-built Pantsir, Tor M2 and SA-8 must be more than 8 NM from another protected CTLD build of the same type on their coalition. The spacing rule also applies to automatic/batch building.

Use capture-capable troops for ordinary capture and supply work. Their pickup origin matters. Troops brought back to their pickup zone, deployed to a friendly zone that does not need supply, or lacking a valid supply origin are handled by the return/refund rules rather than granting an extra friendly-zone delivery. Specialist teams retain their own roles; a troop group is not automatically capture-capable just because it can be carried.

Capture, supply and return-to-base drops inside zones do not add a TroopDrops deployment count. Only eligible drops outside zones count as troop deployments; restored troops do not replay that count. Return/refund handling remains available when troops return to friendly territory even if their pickup source is unknown.

CTLD FARPs can change native ownership in PvP. The former owner cannot continue using services through a stale friendly FARP reference. Do not assume that capturing the native FARP transfers every CTLD ownership record or creates a new scripted conquest reward.

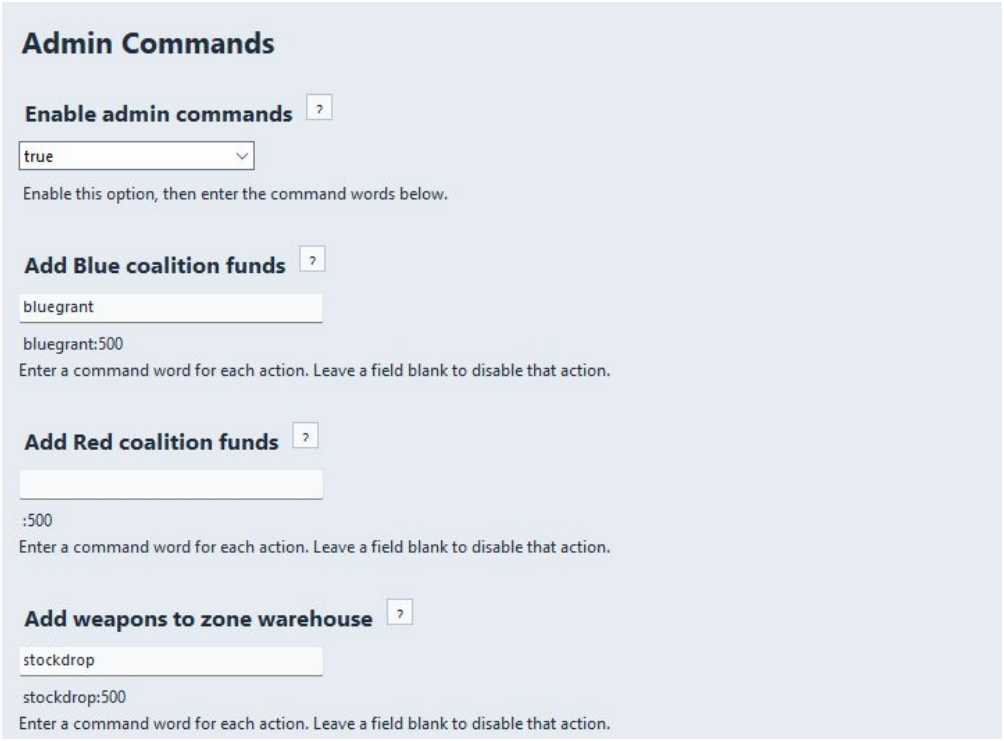
Both coalitions can rescue friendly pilots and capture enemy pilots using eligible aircraft. **Allowed CSAR Aircraft** sets each aircraft's passenger capacity; zero removes its CSAR menu. Use the CSAR reports, markers and pickup instructions, then land in a friendly zone to deliver enemy captives.

Enemy-player-pilot capture has two parts: the configured capture reward per delivered pilot, plus any credits carried by that player pilot when the survivor was created. With player rewards enabled, these use the normal player contribution/reward process; pickup alone does not instantly add the carried amount to the coalition account. Enemy player pilots with carried credits are reported as high-value, without revealing the amount.

AI enemy pilots retain their capture reward and possible interrogation/Intel outcome. Enemy player pilots do not use that AI interrogation roll. Friendly rescue remains the friendly rescue path. Pilot admission, capacity and mission restore limits still apply, so the map does not retain an unlimited number of survivors.

13. Admin Commands

Open **Admin Commands**, enable **Enable admin commands**, and enter your own words under **Command words**. Save and restart the mission. The example beneath each field shows the complete marker format; only the word you enter is saved.



Config Manager Admin Commands: example custom words and a deliberately blank action.

Enabling custom commands replaces the default words for these configurable actions. Leave a field blank to disable that custom action. Turning **Enable admin commands** off returns these actions to the mission's default handling; it is not a master switch that disables every administration feature.

Choose a different word for each action. Matching is exact and case-sensitive. Do not include a colon or line break in the saved word. Blank/whitespace-only words, duplicates and words that collide with reserved gameplay commands are disabled. Use the colon only in the marker text when an action accepts an argument.

The following examples use invented words. First save the shown word in the corresponding field; then use its marker example on the F10 map.

Config Manager action	Example saved word	Example marker and placement
Add Blue coalition funds	bluegrant	bluegrant:500; location does not select the account.
Add Red coalition funds	redgrant	redgrant:500; location does not select the account.
Add weapons to zone warehouse	stockdrop	stockdrop:500 inside the intended zone or CTLD/FARP warehouse area. Word alone uses 50.
List shop / purchase without rank check	supplydesk	supplydesk lists your coalition's shop. supplydesk:<shop-id> purchases; place the marker at the intended target where relevant.
Build ordinary marker FARP	fieldbase	fieldbase at the intended FARP position, outside campaign zones.
Capture eligible neutral zone for Blue	blueclaim	blueclaim inside an eligible active neutral zone.
Capture eligible neutral zone for Red	redclaim	redclaim inside an eligible active neutral zone.
Clear zone built assets	clearsector	clearsector inside the zone. This removes built assets.
Upgrade or repair zone once	repairsector	repairsector inside the zone; suspended zones cannot use this action.
Fully upgrade current-owner zone	finishsector	finishsector inside an active, nonneutral, nonsuspended zone.
Restart mission	roundrestart	roundrestart; the mission/server controls subsequent loading.

Create or edit a coalition map marker to submit the text. These commands do not have an administrator-name or password check in the marker handler. Restrict access to your chosen words through your own server administration practices; the Config Manager's Admin Designer password is a different feature.

Funds change the selected shared coalition account and remain within zero and the configured account cap. Warehouse addition requires Warehouse Logistics and usable storage; it respects weapon restrictions and is not regular [SUP] stock. A rank-bypass purchase still requires an available item, sufficient funds and valid purchase conditions. Marker FARP construction uses the normal FARP builder; PvP allows at most three active FARPs per coalition and requires a compatible national country/template. Neutral capture does not forcibly switch an enemy-owned zone. Full upgrade acts for the zone's current owner. Restart requests the mission restart flag; it does not itself choose a different MIZ or guarantee a same-file reload.

14. End Game, Discord and Support

14.1 Victory and Mission Restart

When you defeat the enemy, you'll see a victory message. The mission can be restarted and the save content will be deleted (both mission and CTLD saves). You can either select yes (mission restarts immediately) or keep flying.

14.2 Community and Support

Join the Discord for updates:
https://discord.gg/cshgmgXuxE
Support me here: https://buymeacoffee.com/lekaa